



Palm Island Community Company

Impact Evaluation



Acknowledgements

We would like to thank the Traditional Owners the Manbarra people, Elders, Bwgcolman people, Palm Island Community Company Staff and Palm Island stakeholders who graciously welcomed us into their world, so we could observe and listen. We would also like to thank the members of the Evaluation Advisory Group, Board members and government stakeholders, without whose input the evaluation would not have not been possible. A number of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people worked hard on Palm Island to make this research and report happen. We would like to thank the local researchers for their insight and wisdom and for keeping the integrity of the voices in our research findings.

Ipsos acknowledges the Traditional Owners of the water, land and sea. Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples who contributed to this research shared with us accumulated knowledge that encompasses spiritual relationships, relationships between people, relationships with the natural environment and the sustainable use of natural resources. This knowledge is reflected in language, narratives, social organisation, values, beliefs and cultural laws and customs. We respect that this knowledge is not static like the written word but responds to change through absorbing new information and adapting to its implications. Therefore, we wish to acknowledge Palm Island Community Company and the Manbarra and Bwgcolman people of Palm Island as joint custodians of these evaluation findings.

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Letter from the Chair of the Board and CEO

On behalf of the PICC Board, I am very pleased to receive this report on the PICC evaluation. The project has been a truly collaborative effort. While initiated and managed by PICC, the evaluation would not have been possible without the participation and financial support of the Queensland Government agencies, (DATSIP, Child Safety and Communities) and the independent expertise of the IPSOS team.

The evaluation findings provide evidence to inform the future directions and priorities for PICC. In particular they confirm the timeliness of the PICC Board's decision to seek shareholder agreement to transition PICC to full community control. This is a significant move and we look forward to working with our key shareholders, the Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council and the Queensland Government, as well as our staff and the community, to ensure that PICC remains a strong, well-governed organisation and meets the needs of the community.

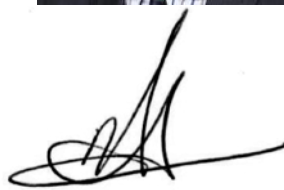
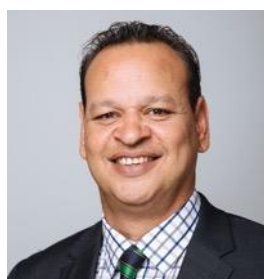
The many achievements detailed in this report are the result of much hard work over many years by the PICC Board, management and staff as well as the support we have received from government and many other partners and stakeholders. The support of Alf Lacey, Mayor Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council in particular has been a highly valued contribution to the evolution of PICC. We should all be proud of our success in creating local employment and the central role local staff play in service delivery.

The evaluation has also given us an opportunity to identify those areas we need to improve and change and we are determined to do just that so that Palm Island has the very best services possible.

We are committed to building on our strengths and working with the community towards self-determination, a better life for all Bwgcolman people and a strong community.

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Rachel Atkinson".

Rachel Atkinson - CEO

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Mislam Sam".

Mislam Sam - Chair of the Board

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1. EVALUATION HIGHLIGHTS

1.1 Evaluation highlights

Palm Island Community Company (PICC) represents a unique governance and service delivery model that has now been operational for over 10 years. PICC is a stable vehicle that attracts state and federal government funding to supply a variety of services on Palm Island. It helps connect Palm Island residents with the right services at the right time and helps to reduce cost of living on Palm Island through local social enterprises. A change in governance from government to community control shareholding is pending. PICC commissioned Ipsos' Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Research Unit to undertake this independent impact evaluation of its effectiveness and to ensure its future directions are informed by reliable and robust evidence. The evaluation has *assessed the outcomes achieved to date, achievements made, the factors contributing to success and the areas for improvement or change* in governance, administration, service delivery and stakeholder engagement.

The evaluation draws on evidence from:

- reviewed documentation, performance reports, government statistics, funding contracts, past evaluations, past economic impact analysis, annual reports and governance documentation
- primary data collected by Ipsos from stakeholders (n=37) and community (n=113) interviews
- primary data collected by PICC from staff (n=51) and community (n=131 of which 98 had used services)
- literature from the Queensland Productivity Commission, Empowered Communities, the National Partnership Agreement on Remote Service Delivery, Stronger Communities for Children and SNAICC.

Key Achievements

- **Workforce** – As at March 2019, the workforce comprises 98 people of whom 85% are Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples and 78% are locals of Palm Island. Within the current cohort, 55% have some form of formal qualification.
- **Governance** – As at March 2019, four of the Board members, including the Chair, are local Palm Islanders and two are non-indigenous.
- **Clients** – In 2018, 3306 clients used a range of PICC services, including 784 unique patients presenting at the Clinic. The 3306 are unique cases to each service; however, some people may have accessed multiple services. PICC services are improving the social and emotional wellbeing of Palm Island residents.
- **Service delivery** – In 2018, PICC was funded for 17 different services or programs by 11 funding organisations across state and federal governments. Quality Accreditation and relevant licencing has been achieved every year.
- **Community** – PICC has facilitated community members' involvement in policy development by helping them participate in reform agendas, most notably the Child Safety Reforms and in ensuring recognition of cultural authority in the Family Participation Program. PICC has also facilitated community voice at a local level through supporting Elders Group, Justice Group, DFV Network, Art Group and Rugby League.
- **Social enterprises** – PICC is creating a new narrative that moves Palm Island from a welfare economy to a place of profit-for-purpose enterprises that provide affordable goods and services, creating local employment opportunities.

- **Strengthening the economy** – economic impact analysis in 2016 of PICC services and employment on Palm Island show \$9.75 million generated in economic output and \$8 million added in Gross Regional Product. Compared to similar communities, the Palm Island community has a higher (equivalised) median household income, stronger employment participation rates and less rental stress.
- **Economic integration** – A larger client base provides economic integration and an environment for community-controlled organisations to grow, become more productive and compete with larger NGOs.

Challenges

It has been challenging for PICC to gain the support of the community for a number of reasons.

Funding modality – The disconnect between how services and programs are funded and how they need to be delivered can result in negative community perceptions attributed to PICC, which is caught in the middle between community expectations and government policy. PICC is trying to work within the funding agreements to best meet community needs and be accountable to funders. Its actions are often misunderstood by the community, which affects the level of generalised trust in the organisation.

Governance model – PICC has two Ordinary Shareholders, Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council and the Queensland Government. The latter has generated negative community perceptions about the level of local decision-making authority that PICC Board members or the community in general have. Communication around how PICC supports the community have not been successful, and the community grapevine becomes the main source of information about PICC.

Lateral violence – Some of PICCs achievements are sometimes undervalued by particular individual or a small group of stakeholders. The Community and Staff survey findings reported levels of lateral violence behaviours amongst the population and PICC has been subject to excessive compliance activities from government based on inaccurate information it received. PICC has worked hard to change how government does business with the community to improve the lives of the Bwgcolman families. Nevertheless, PICC continues to work in an environment where the experiences of local people are

Main success factors

The evaluation undertaken by Ipsos has identified the following success factors leading to the performance of, achievements and outcomes of PICC. This input for this assessment is based upon stakeholder and community feedback and survey and interview findings, internal and external stakeholder feedback and service provider feedback as well as an interpretation of effectiveness undertaken by Ipsos in drawing evaluation conclusions.

- **Local Indigenous knowledge** – The local Palm Islanders working for PICC ensure that culturally safe services are delivered appropriately.
- **Local Indigenous leadership** – The Palm Islander Board members ensure that strategic leadership directs PICC to best meet community needs. There are currently four Indigenous and two non-Indigenous Board members.
- **Connector** – PICC is improving health and wellbeing outcomes through empowering Bwgcolman families and the Palm Island community. PICC helps connect Palm Island residents with the right services at the right time and facilitates the connection between families and highly specialised human services providers.
- **Economies of scale** – The number of PICC's funding agreements has created economies of scale resulting in some efficiency and productivity gains but some gaps in funding sources remain in the provision of wraparound holistic service.

influenced by the past and present government policies of remote and discrete Aboriginal communities which foster the development of lateral violence behaviours. Lateral violence is a very complex challenge and must be addressed in conjunction with broader measures to address trauma associated with colonialism.

Areas for strengthening

Led by feedback from stakeholders, service providers and community surveys and consultation, Ipsos has identified that critical areas that could be improved for overall better outcomes relate to:

- Better communication with community members to build generalised trust in PICC
- Address lateral violence and develop approaches that identify and manage complaints.
- Succession planning for senior management roles and Board members to ensure the longevity and stability of PICC.
- Improvement of human resources systems and processes to ensure employee wellbeing and safety is increased.
- Better measurement of impact indicators.

It is acknowledged that PICC already has strategies in place to address many of the HR staffing and system issues identified in this report; although addressing these to the extent required will take time to appropriately identify and build capability of the PICC workforce beyond that which already exists and to identify and implement more sophisticated (but cost effective) HR systems.

It is also acknowledged that while PICC may need to consider how to improve its reputation, communicate with the community and establish a system for better measurement of its impact and positive community outcomes that these are also significant tasks and that no current funding is available to expedite these agendas.

EVALUATION SUMMARY

The evaluation finds that PICC has positive impacts and achievements. However, community members' perceptions are very mixed about what PICC is doing to contribute to improving life on Palm Island. The findings contribute to broader policy deliberations

about community-controlled service delivery in remote and discrete communities but better understanding the challenges experienced and success factors developed by PICC.

Optimal impact is achieved when PICC is relevant, efficient, effective and sustainable.

RELEVANT

PICC is relevant (wanted and valued) by most community and stakeholders. Almost all staff surveyed (91%) felt that working for PICC allows them to contribute to making a positive difference in their community and that PICC was focused on achieving positive outcomes for the Palm Island community.

The Queensland Government StatShot dataset (see Evaluation Findings section) of Palm Island shows disparity in a range of indicators between this population and the Queensland population. This means that highly specialised human services are needed.

PICC provides human services that are critical to the needs of Palm Island residents. Not all residents are aware of or need these services; however, the 3306 clients who do use them need them and want and value them. To deliver the right services to the right people at the right time in the right way requires skilled local staff and cultural knowledge. PICC has enabled approximately 400 Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander staff an opportunity for employment and to develop their skills and capacity. PICC has been able to contribute to improving programs and policies through thought leadership, advocating for community members, consulting with community, showing

compassion and challenging the status quo.

The literature supports community-led decision-making, self-determination and empowerment as important mechanisms for improving health and wellbeing indicators.

A model of Indigenous leadership and Indigenous knowledge is needed to have an impact.

The reputation of PICC is mixed, with diverse views from community and stakeholders about what value it provides to the community. This is largely historical negativity, which is slowly changing. The move to a community controlled governance model brings opportunity for PICC to shape how it wants the community to view it and better communication about PICC's social change goals and successes associated with a profit-for-purpose model.

EFFICIENT

Palm Island is an expensive place to do business, which affects all areas of operation. PICC staff feel it does have a very lean administration structure, despite some community members and stakeholders having the perception that overheads are high.

A large pool of highly skilled local Palm Island staff fill most of the frontline positions in PICC. However, a community this size cannot support full-time specialist professionals so these are well coordinated and integrated as needed from Townsville and elsewhere. Due to the cost and unavailability of housing on Palm Island, fly-in/fly-out (FIFO) workers ensure that the skilled workforce is maintained. This approach remains more cost-effective than relocation for highly skilled professional staff.

PICC has been financially stable and well managed, but it is growing rapidly. It is outgrowing its current policies, systems and processes, which are not always robust and efficient enough to meet the needs of the organisation as it increases in size.

EFFECTIVE

Stakeholders and staff say that without PICC it

would be very difficult to connect individuals, families and the community to the right services they need at the right time. Services say that working with PICC enables them to deliver culturally appropriate services and to engage with clients and community.

The term 'connector' seems to be a good way to describe the ability of PICC to effectively engage, refer and collaborate with clients because the local staff know how to relate to the Palm Island community, and the managers know how to work with the stakeholders they partner with.

As well as connecting people to services, PICC also delivers effective high quality funded services, evidenced by program performance reports, quality audits and client outcomes. PICC has had to be creative and innovative to maximise potential outcomes from what may be limited, constrained or short sighted, or short term funding agreements.

SUSTAINABLE

The commitment by and approach of the Board and the model of operation have changed a serious, fragmented and unstable community situation to one that provides ongoing positive community-level impacts.

It is important to recognise the success PICC has had to date in being a sustainable and well-governed organisation since it started given the issues that existed at commencement, the complexity of working in remote communities, and in the context of the active barriers and challenges created by government policy.

Over this journey it has been essential to rely on external expertise and management to drive performance and strategy in PICC. However, this may need to evolve to provide greater community control in the future and using expert consultants for specific needs. The stability of governance in a new community-controlled model will be critical if PICC is to continue to provide valued high quality human services and employment opportunities for the Palm Island community.

IMPACT

The main impact of PICC for Palm Island is that there is a stable organisation sufficiently equipped to support rapid growth in Indigenous employment and, as a result, in culturally appropriate service delivery.

Quantitative data from this evaluation suggests PICC is impacting positively on many different levels to improve life outcomes on Palm Island (e.g health and child safety). Financial and crime statistics available show improvements in these areas within the community and a stronger position than similar Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities, for example:

- 15 businesses which exceeds business prevalence in similar communities
- A higher weekly equivalised median of \$456 than similar communities (\$402)
- A greater employment participation rate of 41.6% compared to similar communities (39.5%)
- Reduction in rates of offences against the person and drug offences over the past five years and lower rates in these offences in comparison to similar communities.
- Lower rates in offences against property compared to similar communities.

Despite some positive evidence of impact, there is anecdotal recognition that there is more work to be done and scope to achieve further positive outcomes.

Ipsos recommends that PICC establish a system of measuring their impact via a community dashboard of qualitative and quantitative data using Indigenous knowledge and Indigenous data sovereignty principles. This will help inform decision making and support evidencing the success or otherwise of the community controlled model of governance. It is acknowledged that there is no funding available and identified for this administrative process at this time and that PICC may not wish to divert resources to this against the priority of service delivery and client outcomes.



The real strength of PICC is in the number of local people they employ. Good jobs are well paid and this flows on to families' wellbeing and then there are households with a working person as a role model. Our children will see this and it will mean we can write our future.

The governance model of PICC was what Palm Island needed 10 years ago, to create a stable organisation to deliver quality services utilising highly skilled staff and board members.

It is time now for the future of PICC to transition to a community controlled governance model to optimise self-determination and build on the current highly skilled staff and board members.

EVALUATION OF THE PICC MODEL

The development of the PICC model took a considerable time from conception to implementation, in part because it was complex and controversial within government and within the community. PICC was established to achieve:

- good governance and a high level of accountability
- sufficient scale to be cost-effective and financially sustainable
- direct delivery of high quality, effective social services
- improved community capacity
- improved social wellbeing
- economic development.



SUMMARY

Good governance and a high level of accountability

- ✓ YES, and a communications strategy has promoted organisational strengths to community and stakeholders to increase corporate reputation.

Sufficient scale to be cost-effective and financially sustainable

- ✓ Historically YES; however, the next phase of community-controlled health will require PICC to step up another level in organisational structure and capacity.

Direct delivery of high quality, effective social services

- ✓ OFTEN, and more developmental evaluation would improve the refinement of practices and procedures to achieve better client outcomes. PICC will need to consider its role as connector and collaborate to ensure other specialised service providers coming to Palm Island are delivering high quality services.

Improved community capacity

- ✓ YES, and appreciation for the staged and incremental capacity building of staff as a significant achievement and ongoing goal as the organisation grows.

Improved social wellbeing

- ✓ YES at a client level but hard to tell at a community level as the data has limitations and attribution to PICC is difficult.
- ✓ YES as children are not entering out-of-home care, and more work is needed to reunify children currently in care with their families.
- ✓ YES and appreciation for the positive effect that employment of local people in PICC has on the health and wellbeing of their families.

Economic development

- ✓ YES and appreciation that without a local vehicle to attract funding, there may have been less social services spending and jobs in community.
- ✓ YES and appreciation that social enterprises are a long-term strategy to self determination.

1.2 Palm Island Community Company

Summary of the Palm Island Community Company

Sources: 2018 and 2019 PICC Administration data, 2017-18 audited financial records, 2017 PICC Staff Survey and 2018 PICC Community Survey

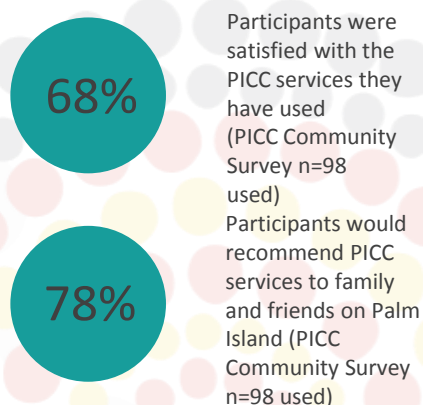
3306 Clients serviced in 2018

	Number of Clients	Male	Female
Disability Service	18	6	12
Diversionary Service	447	258	189
Hub Counselling	106	2	104
Safe Haven	713	370	343
The Hub	311	38	273
Youth Patrol	758	403	355
Medical Service (unique patients)	784	383	401
Women's Services	148	0	148
Safe House	21	13	8

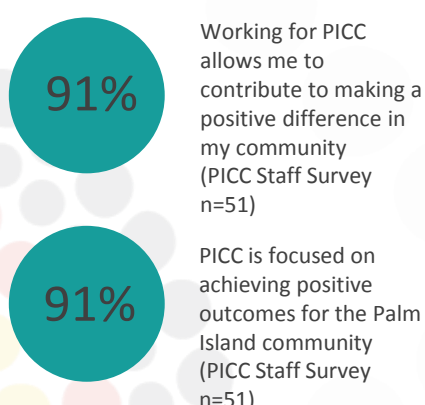
Revenue of \$8,974,803 (2017/18)

\$6,466,435	Grant funding
\$918,400	Sales of goods
\$519,685	Medicare income
\$373,500	Wage subsidy
\$167,641	Grant funding
\$164,526	Practice incentive payments
\$101,520	Rental income
\$263,096	Other

Client satisfaction



Staff satisfaction



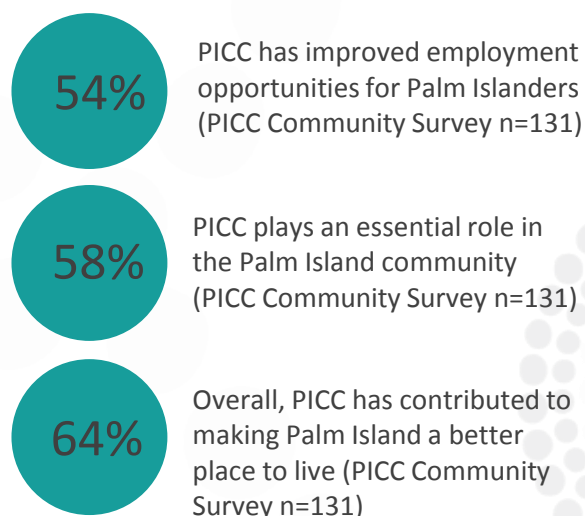
98 Employees in 2019

83

Indigenous staff

15

Non-Indigenous staff

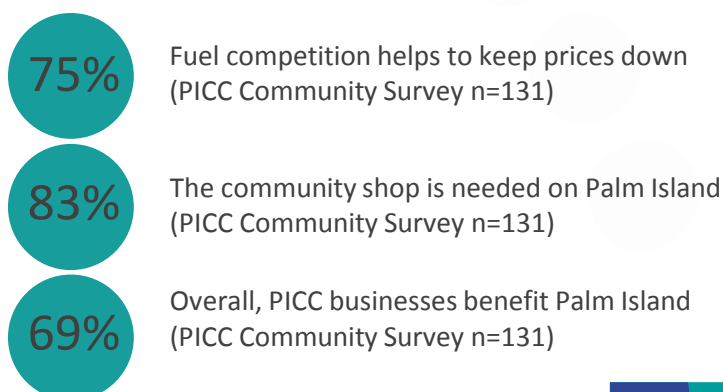


17 Funding agreements in 2017/18

Funding agreements for service delivery in 2017/18 with 11 different agencies in the following sectors:

- 4 Health
- 3 Domestic and family violence
- 3 Families and children
- 3 Early childhood
- 1 Financial assistance
- 1 Youth
- 1 Disability
- 1 Diversionary

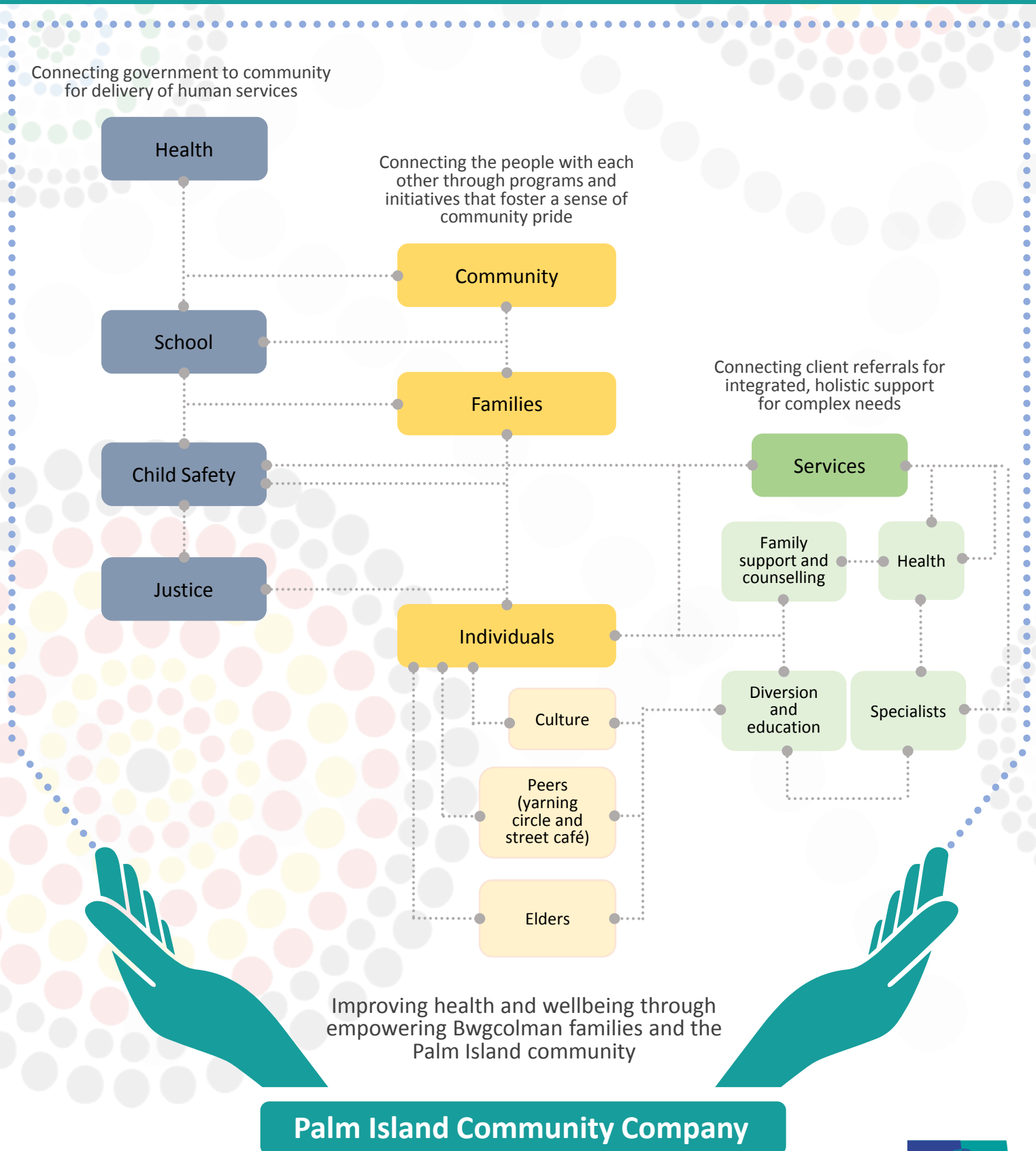
3 Social enterprises



1.3 The Connector

Stakeholders and staff say that without PICC it would be very difficult to connect individuals, families and the community to the right services they need at the right time. Services say that working with PICC enables them to deliver culturally appropriate services and engage with clients and community.

Sources: 2018 Ipsos Community Survey and Stakeholder Interviews



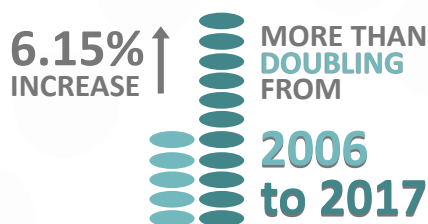
1.4 Social change over time

Many things impact on the movements in this data and what it may mean at community level.

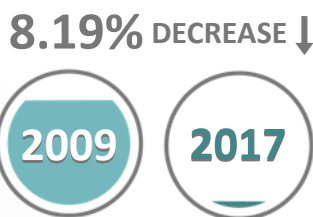
Sources: DATSIP Snapshot Report 2018

DVO breaches have increased. This may mean more awareness, or help-seeking therefore more DVO applications and more opportunity for reporting of breaches. Alcohol-related offences have decreased after implementation of the Alcohol Management Plan. Rates of good order offences, alcohol-related mental and behavioural conditions, offences against the person and assault related injuries have all marginally decreased. The number of youth offenders is becoming a smaller group who are causing a lot of the trouble. The number of youth committing crime is decreasing over time whilst there is still a lot of youth crime happening on Palm Island. The number of children substantiated by the child safety system as being at risk of harm has increased. This may be considered a positive outcome if children at risk are being detected and assessed. Child protection orders have decreased which indicates that safe placements are found without Out Of Home Care (OOHC). School attendance declines since the Remote School Attendance Strategy was implemented in Term 1 2014.

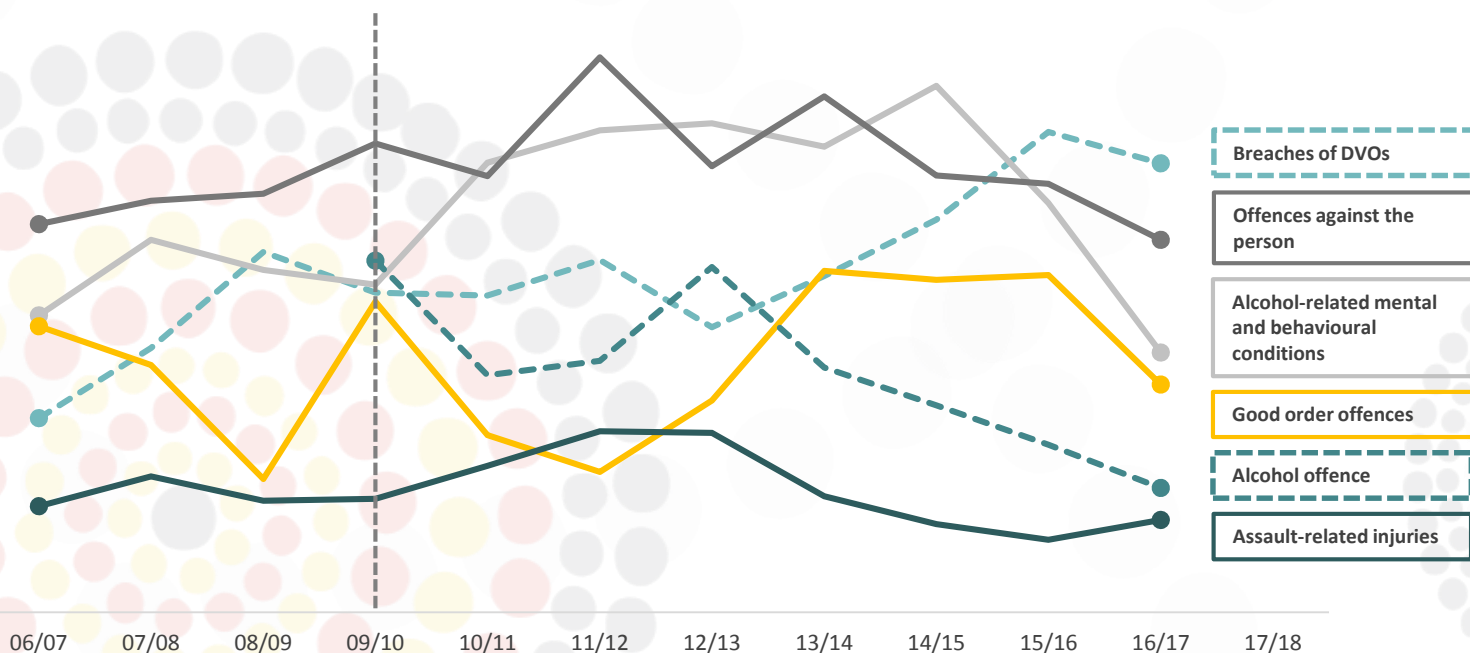
RATES OF DVO BREACHES



RATES OF ALCOHOL OFFENCES



RATES OF GOOD ORDER OFFENCES



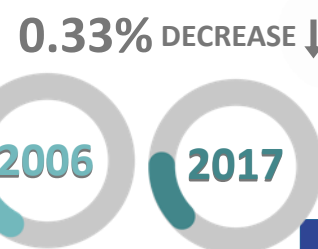
RATES OF ALCOHOL-RELATED MENTAL & BEHAVIOURAL CONDITIONS



RATES OF OFFENCES AGAINST THE PERSON



RATES OF ASSAULT-RELATED INJURIES





2. EVALUATION CONTEXT

2.1 Palm Island: Past to Present

The Palm group of islands is located approximately 65 kilometres north-west of Townsville on the east coast of Queensland, Australia. The biggest island is called Great Palm Island, and other islands in the group include Fantome Island, Curacoa Island, Pelorus Island and Orpheus Island. The community of Palm Island consists of three major settlements: Butler Bay towards the south, the main settlement (known as The Mission) and the Farm.

The Palm group of islands is the traditional country of the Manbarra people, but it is more recently the home of the Bwgcolman, which means ‘many tribes, one people’ and includes people from Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander groups from all around the state. Bwgcolman peoples also include all Manbarra’s immediate neighbours and kin: around Townsville, the Wulgurukaba and Bindal peoples; the Birri Gubba peoples to the south; and other groups to the north and west and further afield in the state.

The early 20th Century was a time of pastoral expansion into North Queensland that resulted in brutal repression and displacement of the local Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples. Some moved to fringe camps around urban areas, to be used as cheap sources of labour, often paid in opium and alcohol (Loos 1993, Highland 1993). The destruction of Hull River settlement, an Aboriginal Mission on the coast north of Townsville, by a cyclone in 1918 led to the gazetting of Palm Island for an Aboriginal Reserve in 1919, which

destroyed the Manbarra people’s land and way of life. After legislative changes in 1934 allowed for forced removal and relocation of Aboriginal people from all parts of Queensland, Palm Island effectively became a penal settlement (Kidd 1997). The population on Palm Island grew with a mix of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people from a huge variety of backgrounds and cultural groups, forced to labour for virtually nothing. In 1957 the Palm Island residents finally held a strike resisting non-Indigenous domination, and requesting improved conditions. Seven ringleaders and their families were handcuffed and forcibly removed to other reserves (Thaiday 1981). Public rallies and protests occurred across Australia over the next 50 years, resulting in small but significant steps towards improving human rights for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people.

In 2004, a death in custody on Palm Island led to civic disturbances, police raids and a legal, political and media sensation. Stability was shattered, and it became difficult for government and non-Indigenous service providers to provide essential social services to the people. PICC was established in 2007 jointly by the Queensland Government and the Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council (PIASC) as a vehicle for delivering services and programs to improve social and economic conditions on Palm Island. The inaugural PICC board first met in November 2007, appointed the inaugural CEO in May 2008 and commenced delivering social services in late 2008.

As a penal settlement, Palm Island was created through forced or lowly paid labour until the late 1970's. Prior to this period, many of the residents of Palm Island worked off the community, the majority in the agricultural and pastoral industries. On Palm Island itself, since the 1970's, there have been a number of changes in employment programs:

- Between 1975 and 1986 people living and working on the community were employed by the Queensland Government, but most were paid wages at less than award rates;
- From late 1986, the Government-paid local workforce was reduced, and those local people employed by the Council or the Government were paid award wages; people not employed by Council or Queensland Government transitioned to CDEP.
- the Remote Jobs and Communities Program (RJCP), which replaced CDEP in 2013 but was not geared to the unique social and labour market circumstances of remote communities
- the Community Development Programme (CDP) in 2015, which replaced RJCP during the change of government.

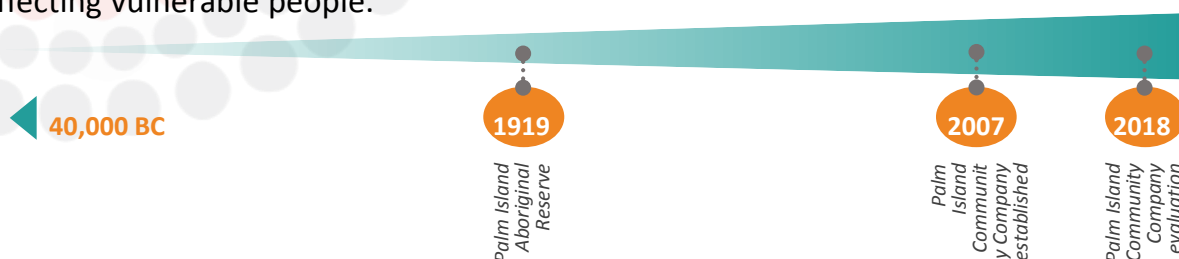
As they live in a remote community, unemployed people on Palm Island who are able to work are required to participate in the Work for the Dole scheme under the CDP. This is a mutual obligation whereby job seekers must work for up to 25 hours per week in exchange for their welfare payment or be financially penalised for non-attendance. In 2017 CDP was criticised in a Senate enquiry for being discriminatory, having inadequate assessment of eligibility criteria, being overly punitive and unfairly affecting vulnerable people.

The Human Rights Law Centre and Aboriginal Peak Organisations have registered their concerns with the Federal Government about the increase in social problems and financial disadvantage felt by remote Indigenous communities since the introduction of CDP in 2015.

While employment is key to improving community wellbeing and outcomes for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people in remote communities, the CDP has had unintended consequences, increasing the demand for health and social services.

Palm Island is now home to one of the largest Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities in Queensland, with different families from many different places. The population fluctuates between 2500 and 3000. Many adults are unemployed, and many individuals and families have multiple complex needs requiring very specialised, high quality human services. In May 2019 a record class action settlement of \$30 million will be awarded to victims of the actions of police in 2004 which breached the *Racial Discrimination Act 1975*. This holds great significance to those involved and is a symbolic win after many years of legal battles, which hopefully brings some closure and healing of the trauma of past events.

The many years of history as a penal settlement led the people of Palm Island to protest against the injustices that colonisation has brought. This desire for equality is still present on Palm Island today and is a powerful force for social change. However, the positive developments the PICC has brought in the last 10 years may be difficult to isolate from the negative effects over the last 100 years.



The political, economic and historical context of Palm Island has created a need for highly specialised human services. The employment policies of RJCP and CDP, which increased financial hardship, affect community wellbeing. The legal proceedings after the 2004 death in custody and subsequent riots were an adverse community event resulting in individual and collective trauma. There is a recognised relationship between community

trauma and domestic and family violence, which has become one of Palm Island's biggest social problems today. Effective community-level strategies to address community trauma must promote community healing and resilience. The most effective strategies to build community resilience build on Indigenous knowledge, expertise and leadership to produce strategies that are culturally relevant and appropriate.



2.2 Palm Island Community Company

PICC was established in the context of major disruptions in national Indigenous policy that included the demise of ATSIC in 2004, the Northern Territory Emergency Response (the Intervention) in 2007, commitments under the Closing the Gap Statement of Intent in 2008, Kevin Rudd's Apology to the Stolen Generations in 2008 and national partnerships agreements on remote Indigenous service delivery and remote Indigenous housing. The period from 2007 to 2017 has continued to be volatile in Indigenous affairs, with significant policy change, two changes of government in Queensland, one change in the national government and numerous changes in ministers and departments responsible for Indigenous affairs and related programs.

The establishment of PICC can be traced to the aftermath of the riot on Palm Island following the 2004 death in custody. The media exposure surrounding the event and a subsequent parliamentary inquiry drew attention to the tensions between the community and the State, to the poor social and economic infrastructure on Palm Island and the high disadvantage experienced by Palm Islanders.

Between 2005 and 2007, the Department of Communities led a process of research and consultation that culminated in the incorporation of PICC. As joint Ordinary Shareholders, the Queensland Government and Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council were partners in the establishment of PICC

and jointly appointed the inaugural Board in November 2007.

In 2007 there was funding that needed to be spent and no effective provider present, as external organisations found it increasingly difficult to work on Palm Island. Creating a stable vehicle to fund was desirable across a number of state and federal government departments. PICC has become a strong stable local supplier and won grants, funding agreements and service agreements.

This response recognised the benefits of community-based rather than government service delivery. The development of the PICC model took a considerable time from conception to implementation, in part because it was complex and controversial within government and within the community.

The aim was to establish an entity that could achieve:

- good governance and a high level of accountability
- sufficient scale to be cost-effective and financially sustainable
- direct delivery of high quality, effective social services
- improved community capacity
- improved social wellbeing
- economic development.

There have been three distinct but overlapping phases of PICC:

1. **Establishment (2007–2009)** – With no capital, staff, offices or systems in place, the focus in this phase was on board development, building relationships within the Palm Island community and with PIASC and government stakeholders, strategic planning, recruiting the CEO and core staff, securing funding, establishing administrative infrastructure (office, policies, systems and communications, etc.) and service delivery infrastructure (facilities, staff, policies, vehicles, etc.).

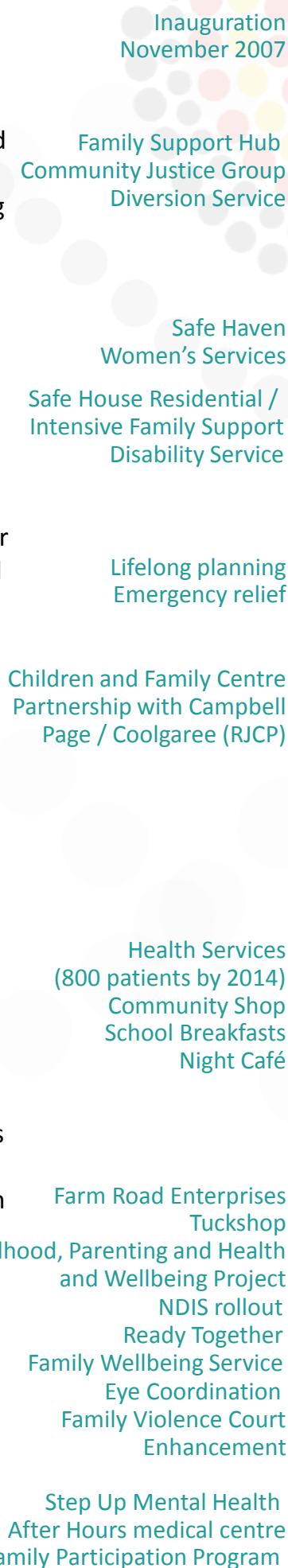
2. **Building social service delivery capacity (2010–2013)** – PICC attracted government funding to expand the range of social services to meet community needs; invested heavily in recruitment, staff training and professional development in order to develop a competent Palm Island workforce; and established quality systems to meet industry and regulatory standards. Other priorities included developing an integrated service delivery model, building networks within the social services sector locally and at state and national levels and securing improved service delivery facilities.

3. **Social enterprises and financial diversification (2014–2018)** – PICC sought to meet community needs while reducing reliance on government funding. This involved expanding into social enterprise initiatives that included partnering with Rotary to convert their Opportunity Shop into a viable retail outlet; establishing a primary health and GP medical service that attracts Medicare and other mainstream income opportunities; re-establishing a bakery and fast food outlet, fuel sales and mechanical workshop following the demise of Coolgaree Aboriginal Corporation; and becoming an NDIS-registered service provider.

The next phase of PICC will include:

- community-controlled health in a new primary health care centre and the implementation of the Palm Island Health Action Plan 2018–2028
- specialist domestic family violence and family wellbeing services and a Family Participation Program
- Transforming governance to full community control.

PICC initiatives and programs



PICC Services

A summary of PICC services and quantum of total funding is provided. As some funding may be used across multiple associated services actual funding figures are not provided.

Sources: PICC Annual Report 2018 and Funded Contracts provided by PICC

Children and Family Centre



The Children and Family Centre offers the Palm Island community access to a wide array of antenatal, postnatal, and parenting support services under the one roof. Children (up to 8yrs) and their families and access important health services, early childhood education, and family support. Services include GPs, Aboriginal health workers, child educators, and family support workers. Broader Centre programs include early childhood education and care, parenting and family support services, and child and maternal health services.

Safe House



The Safe House provides short-term residential placements for children and young people under 18 years old who have been referred from the Department of Child Safety, Youth, and Women. The service provides a place for children and young people on Palm Island that require out-of-home care to remain in their community, allowing them to stay connected to their family, culture, language, and country.

Safe Haven Service



The Palm Island Safe Haven Service provides a culturally responsive service and support to Palm Island children, young people and their families who have experienced or witnessed domestic violence. The service is easily accessible and fully integrated with the Palm Island Family Support Hub. The Night Cafe, Children's Playgroup and School Breakfast programs are the key activities run by the service.

Women's Service



The Palm Island Women's Services provides short-term crisis accommodation and support networks for women and their children experiencing domestic and family violence. It also provides associated services such as general counselling, information, and assistance in applying for Domestic Violence Orders.

Diversionary Service



Operating the Diversion Centre and Community (Adult) Patrol, this service helps to reduce the incidence of deaths in custody by providing a safe, monitored environment for people to sober up as an alternative to police custody.

Medical Centre



The Medical Centre is open to all Palm Islanders. It offers general practice and several specialist medical services, such as for eye health and diabetes, and can give patients access and referrals to related medical services and agencies if needed. An after-hours clinic is offered on some evenings.

Family Wellbeing Services



The Service offers support and help such as personal support and development, information and advice, parenting skills development, kinship connection, budgeting, and household skills development. The Service also coordinates activities such as the Women's Yarning Circle and the Elders' Group. It is also the first point of contact for Emergency Relief Payments.

Stepped Care & Mental Health Team



Stepped Care provides social and emotional wellbeing pathways and tailored services to members of the community who have moderate mental health concerns. The Mental Health Team is new in 2019. The Team is a central coordinating service for all Palm Islanders to comprehensively manage their mental health needs across PICC services and services not provided by PICC.

Community Justice Group (CJG) & Specialist Domestic Violence Service



The CJG program develops strategies within the community for dealing with justice-related issues aimed at decreasing Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders' contact with the justice system. The CJG supports victims and offenders at all stages of the legal process from sentencing, courts and in prisons and detention centres. Since 2008, PICC has provided guidance and support to the CJG. The Specialist Domestic Violence Service opened in April 2019. It provides counselling and support to victims of domestic violence and abuse, as well as support and pathways for users of domestic violence seeking to change their behaviour.

NDIS



PICC is a registered provider of NDIS services for Palm Islanders aged up to 18yrs. A range of NDIS services are provided, all of which are delivered with the unique needs of Palm Island in mind.



2.3 Purpose of the evaluation

PICC represents a unique governance and service delivery model that has now been operational for over 10 years. A number of reviews and evaluations of specific aspects of PICC have been undertaken, including implementation reviews, governance reviews, evaluation of specific programs and activities and accreditation audits. However, PICC has not previously been subject to an organisation-wide evaluation with an emphasis on impact. The PICC Board and management initiated this evaluation to assess the effectiveness of the organisation, ensure its future directions are informed by reliable and robust evidence and to mark the 10th anniversary of the establishment of PICC.

Palm Island has seen considerable change since the inception of PICC. This has included major government investment in capital works, including housing and other infrastructure; a statutory alcohol management regime; work for the dole; expansion of government and community services; and improved transport services. At the same time, PICC has grown significantly, changed and expanded the range of activities and services provided in response to community needs and funding or partnering opportunities. While initially the focus was on social services, more recent growth has included establishment of a primary health service and development of social enterprises. This evaluation provides an opportunity to consider the implications for PICC of these internal and external changes as well as imminent and planned initiatives such as child protection reforms, the construction of a new Palm Island primary health facility and concern by the community and governments for

improved economic development for Palm Island.

The evaluation also provides a vehicle for considering the implications of the findings of the Queensland Productivity Commission Inquiry into service delivery in remote and discrete Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities (QPC 2017) and the Closing the Gap Refresh (COAG 2017).

The purpose of the evaluation was to undertake an independent, robust evaluation of PICC as a means of ensuring transparency, accountability to stakeholders and quality improvement. The evaluation has **assessed the outcomes achieved to date, achievements made, the factors contributing to success and the areas for improvement or change** in governance, administration, service delivery and stakeholder engagement. The evaluation is intended primarily to inform the PICC Board, management and key stakeholders and to influence future directions for the company. In addition, it will support PICC to respond to the emerging needs of the community and changes in the external environment.

The evaluation findings will provide an evidence base for shareholders, the Board, staff, community members, funding agencies and other stakeholders of the impact and achievements of PICC, and will be used to identify issues and priorities for improvement and change. The findings may also contribute to broader Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander policy deliberations, especially as they relate to discrete and remote Aboriginal and Torres Strait communities.

2.4 Contextualising the evaluation questions

The Palm Island Community Company (PICC) Impact Evaluation sought to answer the question: *Has the PICC achieved the intended outcome of a well-governed sustainable vehicle for providing services for the Palm Island community that improves the social and economic wellbeing of individuals, families and the community?*

FUNDING MODALITY

The extent to which PICC can contribute to *social and economic wellbeing at an individual or family level* will depend on the quality of the service delivery they are funded to provide. Family and individual client outcomes must be discussed in the context of the **funding modality of service agreements and community expectation of service quality**.

In 2007 there was funding that needed to be spent and no effective provider present, as external organisations found it increasingly difficult to work on Palm Island.

While in 2007 the creation of PICC served to restart service provision on Palm Island, and this has proved a successful solution, the problem of external funding control remains. PICC has become a strong stable local supplier and won grants, funding agreements and service agreements.

PICC is allocated funding in a way that is predetermined by the funding body. Regardless of whether pre-market consultation is done on Palm Island, the

decision of what to fund and how to fund it is made elsewhere by government.

There is little opportunity for ground-up service innovation or community-led needs assessment or decision-making.

Over time, the number of PICC's funding agreements has created economies of scale resulting in some efficiency and productivity gains but some gaps in resourcing remain in the provision of wraparound holistic services. Administration in and compliance with the service agreements requires staff with specialist skills not usual in the local Palm Island workforce, therefore there is still a need for 'outsider expertise'. Additionally, these staff sometimes have to fly in and out from Townsville due to barriers of technical and legal access to land and buildings which has meant delays in suitable facilities to deliver services as well as housing shortages or high costs on Palm Island.

Using funding to supply services in this way can result in negative community perceptions being attributed to the service providers trying to work within their funding agreements.

The extent to which PICC can contribute to *social and economic wellbeing at a community level* will be determined by how much effort is put into addressing trauma at the population level. Reducing community level trauma will help efforts to prevent violence and improve other aspects of community health. Community-level outcomes must be discussed in the context of the **governance model that has been applied to deliver services on Palm Island**.



GOVERNANCE MODEL

In 2007, the key objective was to create a stable vehicle to deliver desperately needed services to a community in a time of unrest and conflict. Various models of community development have been tried and tested over the previous 10 years in other communities, and the country as a whole was learning what works and what does not for remote Indigenous communities through trial and error.

At the time of implementation, the PICC model was an appropriate response and had a focus on strong stable governance utilising external expertise and a local workforce to deliver high quality services. However, this model's authorising body was not community-owned, as the shareholders were the Queensland Government and PIASC. The board were mostly external experts in the initial set-up, but today the majority of Board members are Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people living on Palm Island.

This approach to the **governance model** generated negative community perceptions at first about the level of local decision-making authority, even when incremental change to move to community control was occurring.

What does the context of Palm Island mean for this evaluation?

1. **Indigenous knowledge perspectives** – Evaluation as a discipline is an imposed Eurocentric practice; for this evaluation to be of value on Palm Island, Bwgcolman knowledge and ways of doing things are incorporated into the engagement, data collection and consultation process. Western knowledge and science underpin the measures and constructs of the methodology. Recommendations respect Bwgcolman people's determination to shape their future.

2. **Indigenous data sovereignty** – Access and availability to data is a cultural, strategic and economic asset. Bwgcolman people have been isolated from the language, control and production of data for Palm Island. Datasets created and controlled by state and federal agencies do not recognise or privilege Indigenous knowledge and worldviews, therefore the indicators in this evaluation may not meet current and future needs of Bwgcolman people to evidence the change they value or the impact community-led decision-making has made.
3. **No one voice** – There are many different voices with varying perceptions and all have to be respected for their point of view. Consensus or majority is not a reality on Palm Island, given the complexity of conflicts in the community since colonisation. Negative sentiments are expected as much as positive sentiments in the contribution to the 10-year story of PICC.
4. **Too soon to tell** – Significant shifts in social indicators may require intergenerational change. The 10 years of data examined for this evaluation may not be enough to see any change.
5. **Community-level data is confusing** – It is quite likely the recent social and political climate on Palm Island has increased demand for social services. This increase may demonstrate not an increase in prevalence or disadvantage, but rather a positive system change where more people have access to social services. Reporting may indicate positive system changes rather than increased prevalence.
6. **Attribution of data** – A critical problem in this impact evaluation is finding evidence that shows the extent to which changes in individuals, families or the community can be attributed to the activities of PICC. Attribution is difficult to prove in a complex system such as human service delivery on Palm Island, because many things may affect the livelihoods of the Bwgcolman people.



3. EVALUATION SUMMARY

3.1 Evaluation summary

Ipsos Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Research Unit (Ipsos) was commissioned to undertake the PICC Impact Evaluation on 11 October 2018. PICC has done significant work in developing an evaluation framework (refer to Appendix for more detail) and governance of the evaluation through the creation of the Evaluation Advisory Group.

Ipsos used a number of different data sources, including government statistics; administration data from service provision reports; and survey data with staff, stakeholders and the people of Palm Island. It is important to understand that often there is not one single view but many perspectives that all hold both truth and subjectivity. Ipsos has pulled these views together to share everyone's voice equally.

Data collection on Palm Island occurred between 29 October 2018 and 9 November 2018. Ipsos evaluators undertook interviews with stakeholder groups. Four local people (two females and two males) were recruited and trained to undertake surveys with the community.

Data sources that inform this report include:



reviewed documentation, performance reports, statistics, funding contracts, past evaluations, annual reports and governance documentation



analysed data from the staff survey (n=51) and community survey (n=131) collected by PICC prior to Ipsos appointment.



literature from the Queensland Productivity Commission, Empowered Communities, the National Partnership Agreement on Remote Service Delivery, Stronger Communities for Children and SNAICC.



37 stakeholder interviews with PICC staff, PICC Board, Elders and service providers in the areas of education, health, police, justice, council and from peak bodies on Palm Island.



Three case studies are provided overview of service delivery.

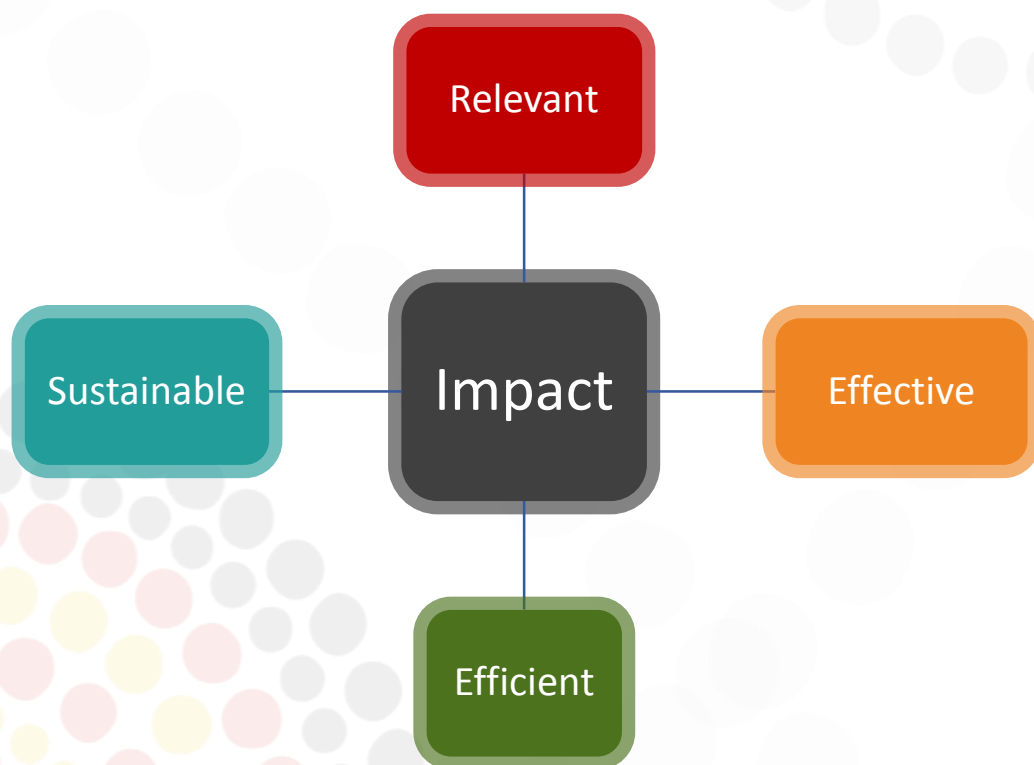


113 qualitative face-to-face interviews with community members conducted by local researchers.



The PICC Impact Evaluation Framework (see methodology section of Appendix for more detail) has been developed by PICC. Ipsos has ordered the evaluation questions into evaluation constructs such as **relevance, effectiveness, efficiency and sustainability** which are needed for PICC to optimise its **impact**.

The evaluation has assessed the *outcomes achieved to date, the factors contributing to success and the areas for improvement or change* in governance, administration, service delivery and stakeholder engagement.



This evaluation is not a prevalence study. The findings are mostly qualitative, which means they are complex, contextual, sometimes consistent and sometimes contradictory. Stakeholders, staff and community members want their diversity understood. There is no single 'Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander voice' nor is there one 'Community' voice. This report contains many strong voices and diverse views that together make up a story about the PICC. The authors caution using a single finding in isolation without consideration of the broader context of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities.

Many issues relate to the extent to which community conflict and lateral violence play out between staff or with clients and the broader community. This is a very important issue for organisations working in discrete Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities. It is very complex and must be addressed in conjunction with broader measures to address trauma and violence within the community.

3.2 Relevant

Summary

PICC is **relevant** (wanted and valued) by most community and stakeholders. Almost all staff surveyed (91%) felt that working for PICC allows them to contribute to making a positive difference in their community and that PICC was focused on achieving positive outcomes for the Palm Island community.

The Queensland Government StatShot dataset (see Evaluation Findings Section) of Palm Island shows disparity in a range of indicators between this population and the Queensland population. This means that highly specialised human services are needed.

PICC provides human services that are critical to the needs of Palm Island residents. Not all residents are aware of or need these services; however, the 3306 clients who do use them need and want and value them. To deliver the right services to the right people at the right time in the right way requires skilled local staff and cultural knowledge. PICC has enabled 83 Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander staff to develop their skills and capacity to better service clients. PICC has been able to contribute to improving programs and policies through thought leadership, advocating for community members, consulting with community, showing compassion and challenging the status quo.

The literature supports community-led decision making, self-determination and empowerment as important mechanisms for improving health and wellbeing indicators. A model of Indigenous leadership and Indigenous knowledge is needed to have an impact. The reputation of PICC is mixed, with diverse views from community and stakeholders about the value it provides to the community. This is largely historical negativity, which is slowly changing. The move to community control brings opportunity for PICC to shape how it wants the community to view it and better communication about the social change goals and successes associated with a profit-for-purpose model. PICC has recognised the importance of community-led decision making and community-control and strategies are already in place for this transition.

Evaluation objective: Is PICC **relevant** (wanted and valued) by community and stakeholders?

Evaluation questions identified as applicable to address under 'relevant':

- How is PICC perceived within the Palm Island community, including by staff, clients and other key stakeholders?
- Do the services provided by PICC respond appropriately to community needs and are they culturally competent?

Overview

Integrated holistic human services are needed because of the historical, social and economic environment on Palm Island. PICC supplies services that are wanted by Palm Island community by connecting clients with the right service that will address all of their needs at the right time when the service is needed. Local staff deliver the service in the right way that is culturally safe and appropriate.

Success factors*

Delivering valued services requires local staff who know and understand the Palm Island community. Local staff value an employer that aims to improve the lives of Palm Island community. In these ways, PICC has been a vehicle for change on Palm Island:

- **A vehicle for capacity strengthening** – PICC provides an opportunity to implement community development principles through strengthening capacity of local Palm Island Board members, management and employees.
- **A vehicle for community voice and consultation** – PICC has facilitated the voice of the community in a number of reform agendas, most notably in shaping the Child Safety Reforms and ensuring recognition of cultural authority in the Family Participation Program. PICC has also facilitated community voice at a local level through supporting Elders Group, Justice Group, DFV Network, Art Group and Rugby League.
- **A vehicle for compassion** – PICC has been able to provide the extra service delivery and support systems that are often outside the scope of funded services or programs. These additional supports are often the things the community most values, for example, assistance for families during funerals, support to do business with a range of other government services, and travel for allied health or preventative health products (e.g. shoes for diabetics) not available on Palm Island.
- **A vehicle for challenging the status quo** – PICC has sought to change the way government does business with remote Indigenous communities by helping facilitate and lobby for developing ground up solutions rather than top down designed programs and funding models.
- **A vehicle for thought leadership** – PICC has provided new points of view on program service delivery, and contributed to success stories changing the narrative about the way Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities are portrayed in the media, in academia and in the human services sector.

*Based upon all evaluation inputs including documentation, internal and external stakeholder opinions, service provider opinions and community feedback Ipsos has compiled a list of relevant success factors. These include those expressed by individuals (where deemed an appropriate judgement) in addition to those identified by Ipsos based upon evaluation processes.

Perceptions of PICC

Staff

- 91% of staff surveyed agree or strongly agree with the statements that 'Working for PICC allows me to contribute to making a positive difference in my community' and that 'PICC is focused on achieving positive outcomes for the Palm Island community'.

Clients

- In the PICC community survey 2018, 68% of clients surveyed were satisfied with the PICC services they have used.
- In the PICC community survey 2018, 78% would recommend them to family and friends.

Community

- In the PICC community survey 2018, 69% of people surveyed said PICC social enterprise businesses benefit Palm Island
- In the IPSOS community and stakeholder survey 2018, qualitative responses showed that a quarter interviewed (27%) unprompted mentioned the Clinic and Children and Family Centre (CFC) is working well, however 11% feel that some services are working well but not all.

A minority of the community does not have clarity on the role of PICC, how it works, what it is funded for and who it can help. There are negative sentiments relating to 'government ownership', 'fairness/equity to all community members', 'nepotism', 'family biases in service delivery' and 'staff safety or harassment in the workplace'. Community gave very positive feedback about seeing the Palm Island local staff get jobs and doing good work.

Stakeholders

Most consider PICC as a valuable and relevant vehicle for delivering services, without which they would not be able to go about their business. PICC is seen as flexible, responsible

and able to 'think outside the box' by some stakeholders. Others feel that PICC can push back and hinder progress for reasons that were not apparent to stakeholders until later. Some felt the 'negotiation and communication and collaboration' was not strong, while others felt PICC was good to work with.

Meeting community needs

There are gaps in what community members expect PICC to deliver and what PICC is funded to deliver. PICC is not funded to deliver transport, financial relief or vouchers, or services for the elderly to the extent that the community wants or needs.

PICC staff also identified social services needed for which there is no funding, for example, transitioning youth back into community after detention and providing intensive support services for 7–12-year-old children and their families in conjunction with school attendance and health needs.

“

They have a few services that I know of but don't really know what each one does. People have come to where I work and asked about how PICC helps out about food vouchers, transport services ... they get directed to PICC but turned away and told it's not what they offer ... it's not in their budget.

“

When PICC first came to Palm I thought there was an agreement where they would assist other community organisations to better their businesses financially and training.

Areas for improvement or change

The reputation of PICC is mixed, with diverse views from community and stakeholders about the value it provides to the community. In some cases this is because there is low association between the services provided and PICC and low awareness of the services they offer. In other cases PICC has a mixed reputation: some say that particular services are working really well, and others say they are not.

PICC faces a number of reputational challenges. It has focused on communications with the Board, the shareholders, service providers and government funders about strong governance, financial stability and sustainability during its establishment years as it built service delivery capacity.

PICC has had to expend significant effort to appease the entrenched bureaucracy of government funding. The risk of the 'funder-centric model' is that it leads to short-term gains in confidence in the sector but has not facilitated the right messaging at a community level. PICC's reputation could be improved by messages that are 'community-centric' and demonstrates how PICC does listens to community and works to meet their needs.

This will be vital as PICC moves to a community-controlled model where the 'shareholders' are different in terms of what builds their confidence and trust.

The contradictions in PICC's reputation is explained by the distinction between personalised trust and generalised trust.

Personalised trust is built up through repeated personal interactions. This trust is reinforced when people regularly use PICC services and know and like the local staff who make the service culturally safe.

It should be recognised there are significant challenges for effective communication within remote communities, which often relates to the level of trust in who is communicating. Furthermore that there is no dedicated funding related to this task.

As not everyone on Palm Island uses PICC services, or the services they use are not associated with PICC, then these people become more reliant on generalised trust.

Having government shareholders and ineffective 'community-centric' messaging has led to low levels of generalised trust among community members.

The move to community control brings opportunity for PICC to shape how it wants the community to view them and better communication about PICC's social change goals and successes and about the profit-for-purpose model.

Context

The Queensland Government StatShot dataset of Palm Island shows disparity in a range of indicators between this population and the Queensland population. This means that highly specialised human services are needed.

The literature supports community-led decision-making, self-determination and empowerment as important mechanisms for improving health and wellbeing indicators. A model of Indigenous leadership and Indigenous knowledge is needed to have an impact.



3.3 Effective

Summary

Stakeholders and staff say that without PICC it would be very difficult to connect individuals, families and the community to the right services they need at the right time. Services say that working with PICC enables them to deliver culturally appropriate services and to engage with clients and community.

The term 'connector' seems to be a good way to describe the ability of PICC to effectively engage, refer and collaborate with clients because the local staff know how to relate to the Palm Island community, and the managers know how to work with the stakeholders they partner with.

As well as connecting people to services, PICC also delivers effective high quality funded services, evidenced by program performance reports, quality audits and client outcomes. However, these short-term programs each have separate funding arrangements, which is a constraint on PICC's effectiveness. To overcome this, PICC has had to be creative and innovative to maximise the potential outcomes from these agreements. This is the constraints in which PICC are expected to be effective. To overcome this, PICC has had to be creative and innovative to maximise potential outcomes from what may be limited, constrained or short sighted funding agreements.

Evaluation objective: Is PICC **effective** (achieving its goals) for clients and community?

Evaluation questions identified as applicable to address under 'effective':

- Are services of a high quality – do they meet industry standards?
- Does the PICC service delivery workforce have the appropriate skills?
- Is PICC well managed?
- Are organisational policies, systems and processes robust and efficient?
- How effective has PICC been in working with other community services and government service delivery agencies?
- How effectively have PICC's services integrated with the service systems on Palm Island and Townsville?
- How do PICC service delivery outcomes compare those in like Aboriginal communities?

Overview

PICC has passed all Human Services Quality Standards (HSQS) audits, Australian General Practice Accreditation Limited (AGPAL) audit, Child Safety licencing and accreditation has successfully maintained industry licensing and regulatory requirements related to the Human Services Quality Standards.

PICC has been financially stable and well managed, but it is growing rapidly. It is outgrowing some of its current policies, systems and processes, which are not always robust and efficient enough to meet the needs of the organisation as it increases in size, particularly in the area of Human Resources.

A large pool of highly skilled local Palm Island staff fill most of the frontline positions in PICC. However, a community this size cannot support full-time specialist professionals so these are well coordinated and integrated as needed from Townsville and elsewhere.

The 2018 community survey showed that 64% of community members agreed that overall, PICC has contributed to making Palm Island a better place to live.

Success factors*

PICC has been very effective in implementing a workforce strategy, providing training and employment for local workers. These local Palm Island staff are Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples who contribute their cultural knowledge and to provide culturally safe services, which is the best method of service provision in remote communities.

- Flexible workplace practices enable staff to be supported by PICC and PICC to maintain a reliable workforce with high retention.
- Reliable local Palm Island staff who are invested in the aims of PICC provide input into service design and direction in service delivery. This local contribution ensures

that services are delivered more effectively and tailored to meet the community's needs better and produce better outcomes.

- Employment opportunities across the organisation enable local Palm Island staff to move positions, learn new parts of the business and diversify their skill sets. Staff who are versatile across the organisation help to backfill staff on leave, facilitate implementation of new programs or funded activities and navigate policy and program changes.
- Local Palm Island staff are always exploring opportunities for continuous improvement. They listen to their clients and community and attempt to keep people satisfied with the services.
- Senior and mid-level management have been consistent, and this continuity of staff has meant operational stability and stable management.
- PICC has negotiated with a range of stakeholders and service providers to bring a range of specialist services and professionals to work in partnership with PICC services on Palm Island.
- Through collaborative practices, PICC is seen as the 'connector'.

The 'connector' persona for the organisation showcases what PICC does best in community as stated by stakeholders: connecting people with the right services at the right time. PICC knows how to relate to the Palm Island community and to the stakeholders they partner with.

*Based upon all evaluation inputs including documentation, internal and external stakeholder opinions, service provider opinions and community feedback Ipsos has compiled a list of relevant success factors. These include those expressed by individuals (where deemed an appropriate judgement) in addition to those identified by Ipsos based upon evaluation processes.

Quality

Services provided are considered to be effective and of high quality. Evidence includes:

- A skilled workforce requires an investment in training. In the 2017/18 financial year, \$78,742 was expended on formal training, which equates to 1.6% of expenditure on salaries and wages. This does not reflect the total training effort, as PICC staff also accessed extensive training opportunities that were not paid for by PICC, which were heavily subsidised or provided by external bodies such as peak bodies (QATSICPP, QAIHC, SNAICC, etc.) and government agencies. This included accredited and non-accredited training and conferences both on and off Palm Island.
- In addition to this, informal internal training and mentoring are delivered by PICC staff. The training register shows that 74 staff attended training and professional development sessions throughout 2018, often on multiple occasions. Some of the training was accredited, such as First Aid Certificate, Certificate in Early Language and Literacy and presentations at state conferences. There is a wide variety of training activities, which are not always captured in the training register.
- HSQS audit, Australian General Practice Accreditation Limited (AGPAL) audit, Child Safety licencing and accreditation have been achieved each year. The most recent assessment in January 2019 achieved conformity for 20 of the 22 indicators of Human Service Quality Standards and two development actions regarding documentation of safety inspections and incident register to proactively prevent, identify and respond to risks to the safety and wellbeing of people using services.

- Staff Survey: Nearly 80% of staff surveyed reported that they had participated (over the past year) in training or professional development.
- The 2018 community survey of 131 community members showed that 53% said they were satisfied with the services they used.

Policies, systems and processes

Policies, systems and procedures are in place as audited by evaluators. Through interviews with staff, it became apparent that the organisation has grown to a size that warrants a better human resources staff management system to support them. Some staff also felt that communication between management in Townville and staff on Palm Island could be improved.

Human resources strategies need to be improved to address the complaints staff currently have regarding bullying, harassment and safety.

Funding agreement performance reports demonstrate compliance with contracts and effective service delivery. The performance reports state that outputs are delivered satisfactorily; however, there are very few measurements of outcomes in the funding agreements that require PICC to provide evidence of effectiveness.

Human Services Quality Standards AUDIT 2018, Executive Summary includes the following comments:

The assessor particularly noted a strong and consistent culture reflective of both the values and the collaborative approach that is embedded in the organisation.

Evidence indicates that the assessed needs of the individual service users are being appropriately addressed and responded to within resource capacity. The organisation uses flexible and inclusive methods to identify the individual strengths, goals and aspirations of people using services. It formulates service delivery that respects and values the individual including their cultural needs and beliefs. Services to individuals are delivered, monitored, reviewed and reassessed in a timely manner. The organisation has effective partnerships and collaborates to enable it to effectively work with community support networks, other organisations and government agencies as relevant and appropriate.

PICC has provided services in the community for ten years and continues to grow and expand many of its program offerings. The establishment and roll out of these programs are as a result of its close engagement with the community that allows it to understand the service gaps and design programs that meet community needs and expectations. Much has been achieved in ten years and PICC owes much of its success and growth to the way it works with the community on a daily basis. Various stakeholders, Palm Island groups and Elders advise and guide the design and implementation of its programs. This collaborative approach allows the organisation to be fully immersed in the community and better understand how it can meet their needs. The Service Manager works in a collaborative way and is well regarded by the community. In addition, there is much evidence of the levels of appreciation of the organisation, the services and supports provided.

Well managed

The Staff Survey showed that perceptions by staff of PICC being well managed are mixed, which suggests that PICC employees are well supported with the functional aspects of their job, but that interpersonal aspects such as health and safety or harassment and violence could be better addressed in the workplace, particularly considering the context of lateral violence in remote communities.

- 89% of staff agree that their job roles and responsibilities are clear.
- 77% of staff agree that PICC provides them with enough resources to perform their jobs well.
- 73% of staff agree that PICC provides them with the training and support they need to do their jobs.
- 71% of staff agree that PICC is genuinely concerned for the health and safety of its employees.

- 66% of staff agree that PICC assists them to deal with harassment by or violence from clients or co-workers in the workplace.

The staff surveyed said they are most likely to receive information about what is going on at 66% of staff agree that PICC assists them to deal with harassment by or violence from clients or co-workers in the workplace. PICC communicates through emails, their supervisor, other work colleagues and *Whichway* (newsletter). The proportion of staff surveyed who thought communication by management was very good or good is:

- 64%: PICC is communicating major decisions and day-to-day issues relevant to their jobs.
- 56%: PICC is keeping them informed on how the company is going.
- 50%: PICC is communicating its planning goals and strategies to them.

This result shows that there is a lot of improvement to be made.

Service integration

Stakeholder interviews and client case studies demonstrate integrated service delivery.

A good sign of integration is that PICC is considered the 'connector' by stakeholders.

There are good examples of client case management and referrals across services. Approximately a third of clients are accessing two or more PICC services. The 2018 community survey of 131 community members further supported the finding that service integration is occurring with 56% agree that PICC supports local community organisations.

Comparison against other Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities

Although the actual PICC service delivery outcomes on Palm Island cannot be directly compared to service delivery outcomes in similar communities Section 3.4.2 provides social indicator metrics available for Palm Island and the communities of Cherbourg, Mornington, Woorabinda and Yarrabah as a point of comparison.

These social metrics may be influenced by many factors, including PICC service delivery, however given the long term involvement of PICC it is reasonable to associate community conditions with the role of PICC in the community.

Compared to like communities, recent data for the Palm Island community shows:

- A higher number of businesses in the community than anticipated for population (15).
- Higher median weekly household income of \$456 compared to an average of \$402 across other communities.
- Higher employment participation rates of 41.6% compared to an average of 39.5% across other communities.
- This has related impacts of benefit to the Palm Island community including:
 - Less rental stress (at 8.1% of low income households compared to 11.5% average).
 - Greater household amenity such as internet access in households (at 56.9% compared to 42.9% on average in 2016).
- Crime offences are better in general compared to other communities. Specifically:
 - Lower rate of offences against the person (67.7 per 1,000 compared to 77.7 on average). On Palm Island this rate of offences against the person have decreased over the five year period from 107.4 per 1,000 in 2012/13).
 - Lower rate of offences against property (128.1 per 1,000 compared to 167.3 on average).
 - Lower rate of offences against a person (24.0 per 1,000 compared to 39.7 on average). On Palm Island this rate of offences against the person have decreased over the five year period from 33.1 per 1,000 in 2012/13).

Palm Island community social indicator data on motor vehicle ownership, education and immunisation are mixed and general equivalent to that within other like communities.

Social indicator data also highlights that the Palm Island community continues to struggle against social issues including homelessness and domestic violence.

Both rates of homelessness within the population and rates of breaches of DVOs are higher than the average rates across like Queensland communities.

PICC is aware of the issue of increasing DFV statistics within the community and is working to address the problem with a men's diversionary service. PICC has been awarded a DFV intensive support service contract commenced in 2019.

Areas for improvement

Increase flexibility through a pooled funding modality could help improve the effectiveness of program and service delivery through more strategic use of the workforce and infrastructure.

The physical office space for PICC on Palm Island is cramped and insufficient for a growing organisation. The difficulty in acquiring decent office facilities on Palm Island limits the opportunities for growth and collaboration that occurs in shared spaces.

A set of PICC key performance indicators (KPIs) across all programs would help to define and demonstrate success against PICC goals.

During qualitative interviews staff felt that the need for mid-level management to handle more of the day-to-day operations, allowing the senior management to focus more on strategy.

There is also a need to increase the level of sophistication of software and systems so that they better support PICC's human resources and KPI reporting of outcomes and achievements in effective service delivery to management and the Board.

Context

There are recommendations from the Queensland Productivity Commission Inquiry into service delivery in remote and discrete Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities that reflect the challenges PICC faces in delivering services effectively on Palm Island. The short-term siloed funding modality, in particular, is not conducive to effective service delivery, which is a constraint on PICC's effectiveness. PICC has had to be creative and innovative to maximise the potential outcomes from these agreements.



I think the Medical Centre is working ... and the majority of staff are local people, which makes service delivery more culturally warming and accepting.



[PICC is doing well in] providing opportunities for local employment, striving to get more and better services on Palm.

3.4 Efficient

Summary

Palm Island is an expensive place to do business, which affects all areas of operation. PICC staff feel it is a very lean administration structure, despite some community members and stakeholders having the perception that overheads are high.

A large pool of highly skilled local Palm Island staff fill most of the frontline positions in PICC. This is an efficient way to deliver services in remote communities. However, a community this size cannot support full-time specialist professionals so these are well coordinated and integrated as needed from Townsville and elsewhere. Due to the cost and unavailability of housing on Palm Island fly-in/fly-out (FIFO) workers ensure that the skilled workforce is maintained. This approach remains more cost-effective than relocation for highly skilled professional staff.

Evaluation objective: Is PICC **efficient** (optimising its resources) to get the best outcomes?

Evaluation questions identified as applicable to address under 'efficient':

Is PICC service delivery cost-effective, and how well do costs compare with those in like Aboriginal communities?

Overview

- PICC's financial reporting meets service agreement requirements.
- Compliance with the Queensland Audit Officer's external auditor was more onerous than most other Indigenous community-controlled organisations would need to undertake.
- Statutory accounts were prepared in a timely manner.

Success factors*

The level of skill of the Board and management and the ability to access other professionals to assist PICC has ensured a high level of due diligence across financial management and cost efficiencies.

Areas that helped PICC to be cost-effective are:

- highly trained, productive staff
- experienced financial manager and senior management
- use of FIFO workers to ensure that a skilled workforce is maintained; this is more cost-effective than relocation for highly skilled professional staff.

Economies of scale – Having many contracts and a pool of highly skilled staff helps PICC weather the stop/start or short-term nature of funding agreements. This helps flatten the uncertainty and contractual nature of funding. It also means that new services or programs can be quickly and effectively implemented. It can also create efficiencies in administrative costs when shared corporate services such as training, IT, HR and business support.

Economic integration – More funded services means access to a larger client base, a greater pool of qualified workers, additional sources of financing and greater need for better technology. A larger client base, through more funded agreements, can start to even the playing field of a small organisation to compete with the large NGO elites. The increased inertia of gaining multiple revenue streams and limitations in the funding agreements can encourage innovation and drive efficiency out of necessity. In other words, economic integration can create an environment for community-controlled organisations to grow, become more productive and compete with larger NGOs.

Financially, some of PICC's success factors are:

- PICC is working within funding agreement budgets.
- Economies of scale of funding allows for 'value adding' of services to better meet community expectations.
- Profit-for-purpose social enterprises can repurpose profits for community activities and unmet needs.

*Based upon all evaluation inputs including documentation, internal and external stakeholder opinions, service provider opinions and community feedback Ipsos has compiled a list of relevant success factors. These include those expressed by individuals (where deemed an appropriate judgement) in addition to those identified by Ipsos based upon evaluation processes.

Employment data

There are 98 employees as at March 2019. Of these, 83 identify as Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people.

A flat employment structure is cost-effective but not efficient when senior management are doing mid-level operational management. This leads to a reduction in effectiveness which PICC have realised and are in the process of changing.

Having more local staff in management roles is seen to be important by community members to improve efficiencies for PICC. This may ultimately reduce travel costs between Palm Island and Townsville.

Having an office in Townsville has a number of advantages for doing business more efficiently with funders and contract managers.

However, some staff felt that the communication between offices could be improved to create better efficiencies and minimise delays and rework or oversights. Suggestions from staff for improving communication could be achieved by staff meeting each other, and Townsville staff coming to Palm Island to better understand the context in which they work.

Community perceptions

In the community interviews, some people said that they feel they are not well informed about distribution of funds and costs of service delivery. Despite this lack of understanding, some concerns are evident among members of the community about appropriateness of funds usage.

- There is a perception that FIFO workers are not cost-effective and that this travel money could be better spent on Palm Island. The lack of housing and small employable staff pool on Palm Island necessitates FIFO and because of this, it is not something PICC has control over.

- There is a perception that FIFO workers do not add to the economy of Palm Island, because they do not purchase from local businesses.
- Use of FIFO workers may contribute to some of the community concern about appropriate hiring and employment practices for positions available. However, the necessity for FIFO in some highly specialised positions is justified.
- There is a perception that the Townsville office is an extra cost that is not needed.
- Positions being funded at 0.5 FTE, which means some staff work across two programs, can be perceived as one person getting all the jobs.

Stakeholder perceptions

Stakeholders are unwilling to comment strongly on the appropriateness of fund usage and cost efficiencies. They consider that the PICC model and context cannot be compared directly against other circumstances in like Aboriginal communities due to the uniqueness of each situation. Despite this, a few perceptions exist among some stakeholders:

- that PICC adds higher administration fees than others (such as bigger not-for-profits who perhaps can absorb these costs)
- that PICC should be cheaper because they have a higher proportion of local workforce
- that PICC will be able to find money from other funding agreements if a program is not sufficiently funded to be effective (i.e. this is both a pro and a con of becoming the main player in the market for tendering for services).

Discussion

Perceptions of appropriate use of available funding and cost-efficiency expectations differ substantially depending on the level of actual financial understanding versus perceptions of how much staffing and services cost to run. Individuals who are not well informed can easily hold a perception that the situation could be improved regarding effective fund usage and allocation.

PICC needs to more actively control these potential misconceptions, especially if they have the potential to harm the way it is perceived among the community. It is time for PICC to tell a new story. PICC staff feel the organisation runs on a very lean budget – but often, that is not how it is perceived by community and stakeholders. Suggestions from staff was that the focus should not be on communicating operational efficiency (leading to misinformed criticism) but on the ‘heroes’ of the story: the dedicated staff who do what it takes to get the job done, who have the special skills that benefit PICC and the Palm Island community.

Although the flat organisational structure is cost-effective, the structure would be strengthened with mid-level employees who focus on the day-to-day operations so that senior level staff can implement strategic recommendations. There is not a lot of administration support in place for employees to help manage the organisation and enable senior managers to work more strategically. PICC understands this and is working to address it.

Better human resources strategies could also help to manage the current staffing issues and develop the internal culture to lift productivity and allow more time for strategic thinking. PICC currently has an agenda to address human resources and systems in progress.

Context

Palm Island is an expensive place to do business, which affects all areas of operation.

Due to the cost and unavailability of housing on Palm Island, FIFO workers ensure that the skilled workforce is maintained. This approach remains more cost-effective than relocation for highly skilled professional staff.

The perceptions of staff, stakeholders and community in remote communities can often be highly critical of external non-Indigenous staff and highly supportive of local staff. However, the reality that a small community would have the depth and breath of skills for all skills required for a sustainable full time job is not necessarily the case now, but certainly aspirational.



....operating on the smell of an oily rag.



Giving a job to certain people and not advertising it or replying to the people who applied to inform them the job is taken. Constantly getting asked by community people why people getting jobs and not going through the process.



And also your management staff is top heavy with non-Indigenous who fly in and fly out.

3.5 Impact

Summary

The main impact of PICC for Palm Island is that there is a stable organisation sufficiently equipped to support rapid growth in Indigenous employment and, as a result, in culturally appropriate service delivery.

Quantitative data from this evaluation suggests PICC is impacting positively on many different levels to improve life outcomes on Palm Island. Publicly available social indicator data provides an indication that the community is moving forward in household financial circumstances and reductions in crime offence rates. There is anecdotal recognition that there is more work to be done and scope to achieve further positive outcomes.

Ipsos recommends that PICC establish a system of measuring their impact via a community dashboard of qualitative and quantitative data using Indigenous knowledge and Indigenous data sovereignty principles. This will help inform decision making and support evidencing the success or otherwise of the community controlled model of governance. It is acknowledged that there is no funding available and identified for this administrative process at this time and that PICC may not wish to divert resources to this against the priority of service delivery and client outcomes.

Evaluation objective: Is PICC **impacting** (making a difference) the individuals, families and community of Palm Island?

Evaluation questions identified as applicable to address under 'impact':

- What social outcomes can be attributed to PICC?
- What economic outcomes can be attributed to PICC?
- How successful has PICC been in building community capacity?
- What are the key factors contributing to PICC's success?
- To what extent and in what ways is the PICC model transferable to other Aboriginal communities?

Overview

Quantitative data from this evaluation suggests PICC is impacting positively on many different levels, also improving quality of life. There is anecdotal evidence that positive impacts are occurring and recognition that there is more work to be done to achieve further positive outcomes.

The main impact is a stable organisation sufficiently equipped to support rapid growth in Indigenous employment and, as a result, culturally appropriate service delivery.

Success factors

Integral to the values, culture and operational practice of PICC is that the organisation:

- employs locally where possible so that staff understand the Palm Island community and what will make a difference
- consults with and is a voice for the community
- strengthens capacity of individuals, staff, managers and Board members to deliver the positive outcomes required
- leads thinking and strategy and challenges the status quo in order to influence the application of government funding and program delivery in Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities.

Although PICC started from the ground up with limited existing resources, PICC has existed in the community for 10 years, gaining traction in service provision.

Community members are having increasingly positive interactions with PICC staff and services, which continues the process of embedding the organisation in the community as a culturally appropriate service provider. It has taken time for these positive interactions to improve levels of trust and positive sentiment for PICC.

The Health Clinic is an example of a highly successful service delivering positive outcomes daily. Key success factors include the employment of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander local staff, culturally appropriate service delivery, widespread applicability to the community and efficiency of service delivery and outcomes.

Economic outcomes

Economic outcomes are hard to measure in exact financial terms:

- For every local employee there is one less unemployed person in the Palm Island community and one less household with no people employed. Currently, 76 locally based staff are employed by PICC. In 2016 the Economic Assessment by Empowered Economics found corresponding to this are increases in employment of 61 jobs, \$5.826 million wages and salaries, and \$7.995 million in terms of value-added.
- The social enterprise activities result in real savings for community members on essentials such as bread and fuel.
- The third most common response from community members interviewed about how PICC services helped them was 'financially'.

An Economic Impact Assessment commissioned by PICC in 2016 and undertaken by Empowered Economics identified economic impacts of:

- \$9.75 million in economic output
- \$8 million added in Gross Regional Product
- 75% of PICC expenditure is spend on labour costs (of which 78% of those in Q1 2019 were local employees) and client related costs for members of the community.

*Based upon all evaluation inputs including documentation, internal and external stakeholder opinions, service provider opinions and community feedback Ipsos has compiled a list of relevant success factors. These include those expressed by individuals (where deemed an appropriate judgement) in addition to those identified by Ipsos based upon evaluation processes.

Publicly available government data for Palm Island compared against the like communities of Cherbourg, Mornington, Woorabinda and Yarrabah highlight that the Palm Island community has:

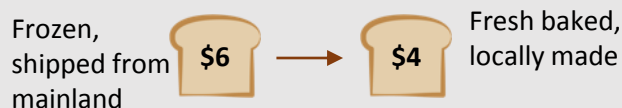
- A higher number of businesses in the community than anticipated for population (15).
- Higher median (equivalised) weekly household income of \$456 compared to an average of \$402 across other communities.
- Higher employment participation rates of 41.6% compared to an average of 39.5% across other communities.
- This has related impacts of benefit to the Palm Island community including:
 - Less rental stress (at 8.1% of low income households compared to 11.5% average).
 - Greater household amenity such as internet access in households (at 56.9% compared to 42.9% on average in 2016).

Social outcomes

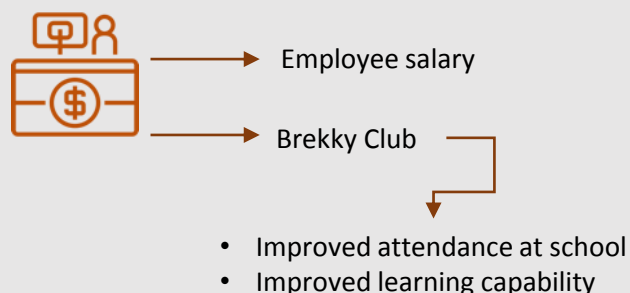
Data about employment and finances are influenced by many factors, making it hard to attribute improvements directly to PICC activities and service delivery. But the statistics do not convey the reality of the social outcomes experienced by Palm Island community members.

Examples of social outcomes

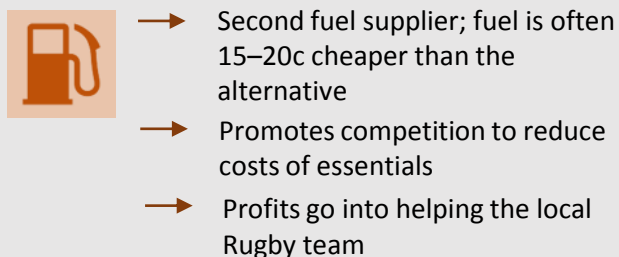
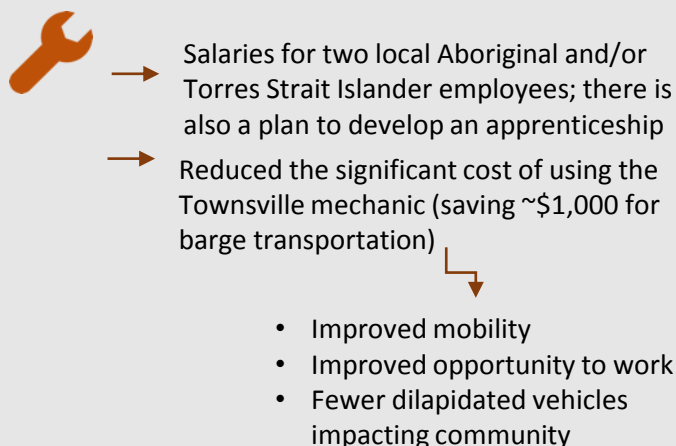
Bakery



Tuckshop



Mechanic



Some of the significant outcomes include:

- 78% of community members surveyed had used at least one PICC service. The most significant change is that clients feel comfortable, safe, relaxed and happy to be using PICC services because they are in a culturally safe space and the staff make them feel welcomed and are not judgemental. This then has a direct flow-on effect to enabling future use of services. Half the clients surveyed (54%) agreed that due to PICC services 'my life has improved' and they are 'better able to deal with life's problems' (55%).
- The PICC community survey results also highlight that PICC is providing needed services and jobs for locals, that it supports community organisations, can be relied on in a disaster and listens to the community.
- The Clinic has made a significant impact in reducing the time it takes for community members to see doctors and specialists (especially for eye, ear and mental health issues). Approximately a third (35%) of community members interviewed unprompted said they experienced significantly less waiting time, and 20% have access to an 'ongoing, good, fast health service'.
- Service availability has increased on Palm Island, allowing the community to have similar access to services as residents in Townsville. This includes the range of services, ability to access specialist skills and increased weekend access to goods and services.
- There are also less immediate outcomes for the community as a result of PICC activities and local employment. All of the PICC activities are increasing the chances of all households having at least one person bringing an income home. If life on the Island is more affordable and accessible services and there are more sources of income, families are in a better position to bring displaced children back into their household. Currently, 90 children are in out-of-home care and working towards reunification.

Community capability outcomes

Stakeholders further highlight that PICC has a high number of local employees who can engage appropriately with families and individuals, which enables service delivery to be more effective to gain traction within the community. Currently PICC employs 76 locals and provides workforce training and upskilling. Over the 10-year period, a total of 457 staff have been employed by PICC. A conservative assumption (as Indigeneity was not recorded throughout the whole period) that 75% of these people are Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people from Palm Island, then that means that around 350 local people have been employed in some capacity by PICC over the decade.

The building of capacity in the workforce has multiple benefits to the community:

- Drawing on external expertise as well as local knowledge builds both community leadership and governance skills within PICC and the local community. This is a both-ways relationship, with both PICC and the community benefiting from this blend of skills and technical versus cultural expertise.
- The breadth of the workforce across PICC activities and services creates multiple entry points as well as career pathways that local employees can benefit from. Roles include medical, social and mental health disciplines; retail; mechanics; administration and cleaning; and program and service officers and workers.
- PICC invests in ongoing professional development opportunities for local employees and continues to explore options for engaging youth, such as the school-based trainees.

Transferability

Application of the PICC model and learnings related to service delivery are only relevant if the same context and circumstances are present in other Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities. Each community has its own strengths, and any model of them should be built ground up, not imported from Palm Island just because it worked there.

However, certain learnings are appropriate to strategically consider in other communities:

- A service delivery model can best be developed by consulting with community, stakeholders and leaders and through consideration of the community context.
 - Where skills and circumstances allow, the workforce should be largely local and of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander heritage to allow best engagement in a culturally appropriate manner. This will not only grow employment but will also encourage use and acceptance of services.
 - External specialist skills are likely to still be required; however, these should also be used to build capability of local workers.
 - Services that cater to the broad community, such as culturally appropriate and skilled medical facilities, may provide early 'wins' in service delivery. Other services, such as food and transportation support, also have wide application.
 - Appropriate human resource functions are needed to support staff, management and organisational appropriateness.
 - Flexible workplace practices can help to maintain a reliable workforce.
 - A long-term, consistent and concerted program is required. Stability is key to achieving long-term impacts.
- made some significant improvements in connecting families to other services they need, which in turn has improved wellbeing for some families.
- There has been a reduction in children entering care in the last three years; however, reunification for those already in care has not yet improved.
 - Domestic family violence (DFV) is considered the largest social and criminal issue on Palm Island. Increased rates of DFV shown in the statistics are thought to be due to increased reporting as awareness and support improve and with changes in the justice system. PICC is working to address the problem through a range of programs and a men's Diversionary Service, but there is little evaluation of program outcomes and measurement technique for these programs are only recently emerging in literature and theory. PICC has been awarded a DFV intensive support service contract commenced in 2019.
 - There are gaps in the funding for prevention of DFV such as relationship counselling or social norm changes, and there has been no trauma mapping on Palm Island to better understand and address the underlying contributors such as community level trauma to DFV.
 - The justice system works after offences have been committed. PICC has limited funding and resources for diversionary programs to prevent offences, but has funding for post-offence responses.
 - The school has worked better with PICC in the last 12 months, with the appointment of a full time guidance officer. A positive working relationship has been established, and there is great evidence of the better engagement to refer families to services.

Client outcomes

The Children and Family Centre (CFC) and a range of funded early childhood programs have

- Some children who are not enrolled in school nevertheless attend, so improvements in attendance do not get reflected in the enrolment statistics. Good outcomes for children under seven years requiring speech pathologists and occupational therapists are emerging.
- Those families and individuals who do access a service that meets their needs are generally very happy with the service, staff professionalism and support provided.
- There is low awareness of the range of services by some community members and some views that some families have preferential access to those services.

Service outcomes

Most clients are positive about the service interactions and changes in their lives they have seen since using services. Some clients have mixed views about the quality of service provision. Negative perceptions occur when the funding agreement does not cover the level of service clients expect.

- The service expectations of community do not always match the funders' expectations, and this disconnect leaves PICC caught in the middle stretching resources to make service provision work better on the ground.
- The PICC has a large local Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander workforce that has demonstrated good skills and knowledge for their current roles. PICC is growing, and the workforce will need to grow with it.
- The barriers to achieving better service integration on the ground and optimisation of resources are the funding modality of short-term contracts and siloed agency funding agreements.

While some funding agreements have extended time periods, such as 3–5 years, most funding cycles are short and staff felt that it could be unsustainable leaving the organisation open to high risk to staff attrition and low return on investment for training. The resilience and flexibility of the organisation are key strengths to ensuring the sustainability of service delivery.



I am an elder and I live in a tin shack. When the storms come they've allowed me to stay in [the women's shelter] for up to two months. I found the women's shelter a blessing for me when I needed them. The Clinic supports me with their help for my health. The doctors are different at PICC to the hospital ... they listen to you and make you feel comfortable. Family-orientated, not just a number. Staff are lovely and welcoming at any time. The transport service go out of their way to pick me up and drop me off to my home. Yarning circle – I love it because it allows us to share with other women.



The medical centre helps a lot. I work full time and it's helped me because they're extended opening hours, late appointments. Youth support transport service is helpful for me and my family – travel and transport services to get us home safely. The night café has and is providing support for kids in the way of supper ... My family access this every night; it is a good thing.

Community outcomes summary

The government statistics in the StatShot report are provided in Section 3.4.1. Key changes are:

- There are improvements in alcohol-related issues, with a reduction in adult alcohol-related mental health and behavioural conditions, alcohol cartage offences and good order offences.
- There have been improvements in child health, with increases in antenatal visit rates and decreases in preventable episodes of care.
- School attendance has increased; however, it is still well under state averages, and enrolment and disengaged rates were not available. This may mean that those enrolled in school are going more often, but some may not be going at all.
- Crime statistics are often skewed by a few individuals and can vary significantly based on the activity of these people. The number of breaches for DFV orders has significantly increased over the past two years.
- While child protection orders have declined, the rate of substantiated notifications of harm has almost doubled in 2018. This may mean that more children at risk are being detected and placed with family outside of the child protection system. The number of young offenders has significantly dropped but the number of offences has not, which might indicate it is a smaller number of young people who are repeat offenders.

Publicly available government statistics comparing Palm Island to like communities (Section 3.4.2) show that in some areas the Palm Island community is stronger than other communities:

- Previously referenced median household income (\$456 per week compared to \$402 across other communities) and higher employment participation rates (41.6% compared to 39.5% across other communities) have an impact on reduced rates of rental stress in low income households and greater household amenity.
- Improvements in crime statistics were noted over the past five year period for offences against the person and drug offences. Palm Island has a lower rate of offences of these types on comparison to like communities. Palm Island also has a lower rate of offences against property compared to like communities however, this has increased over the past five years.

This comparative data further highlights the issue of DFV within the community but also highlights a higher than average rate of homelessness.

Context

Statistical data about people does not reveal the impact that services can have on them. Many influences affect changes in metrics of health or other measurements taken about people, and increases or decreases in statistical values do not indicate how much of a positive or negative outcome this is for the people in the community. Changes in community data can only be understood in the context of qualitative data from that community.

It is acknowledged that there is no funding available and identified for this administrative process at this time and that PICC may not wish to divert resources to this against the priority of service delivery and client outcomes.

Additional benefits

The expectations for PICC to make a difference to social outcomes are high from community and government stakeholders. Other diverse NGOs in mainstream do not have the same burden of expectations as PICC does. For instance, other NGO's would not be expected to "reduce community level trauma", "improve economic wellbeing" and other lofty aspirations outside of their funded programs. However, these are the additional benefits that PICC delivers. In the move to community control, there is a sense of continued high expectations.

PICC maintains a number of informal community roles, such as disaster recovery and coordination for instance, yet does not have a generic or whole of community family support hub that would have a broad target group (outside of funded client groups) to deliver general emotional and practical support in adverse situations.

Areas for improvement

Measurement of the impact of PICC services needs to be strengthened through better monitoring, learning and evaluation frameworks. This will also assist all parties, including government and community, to have a common understanding of social indicators through sharing data.

To support better data, anecdotal evidence and developing stories about the local 'heroes' of PICC will be very powerful in consistently framing the narrative and generating advocacy. The focus needs to be on 'employing locals who are the right ones to deliver services their way' with a guiding hand.

The current model was what the community needed 10 years ago, and it has been a good vehicle. But the future of PICC is in a transition to community control.

3.6 Sustainable

Summary

The commitment by and approach of the Board and the model of operation have changed a serious, fragmented and unstable community situation to one that provides ongoing positive community-level impacts. PICC relies heavily on the good will, generosity of board, staff and community to achieve many of the organisational results. Volunteers include Elders, a great deal of Board work, some staff time, justice group and other community members. The CEO has been consistent since the inception of PICC and her aspirations for Palm people has driven the acquisition of new and innovative services. These factors have ensured the sustainability of PICC to date.

It is worth noting that PICC receives no core funding, and organisational outcomes are a positive consequence despite the condition to deliver services in departmental or jurisdictional silos. It is important to recognise the success PICC has had to date in being a sustainable and well-governed organisation since it started given the issues that existed at commencement, in the context of the active barriers and challenges created by government policy and the remote community context.

Over this journey it has been essential to rely on external expertise and management to drive performance and strategy in PICC. However, this may need to evolve to provide greater community control in the future and using expert consultants for specific needs. The stability of governance in a new community-controlled model will be critical if PICC is to continue to provide valued high quality human services and employment opportunities for the Palm Island community. PICC has recognised this and is moving towards a strategy of implementing community-controlled governance; however, progress to this will take time as it involves increases to human resource capabilities, decision making processes and changes to the nature of the relationship with the Palm Island community and how they view PICC.

Evaluation objective: Is PICC sustainable (continuity of business) to keep doing what they are doing?

Evaluation questions identified as applicable to address under 'sustainable':

- What are the strengths and limitations of the PICC ownership and governance model?
- What changes to the ownership and governance model are needed and appropriate for the future?
- Is the company organisationally and financially sustainable?
- What are the strengths and limitations of the PICC service delivery model?
- What are the critical constraints, challenges and risks faced by PICC?
- What are the key areas for improvement or change?
- What developments or changes are occurring or planned for Palm Island that may impact on PICC and how should PICC change or adapt in response?

Overview

Sustainability in part is about how well the organisation can work more independently of government, as government is one of their high risks, in terms of both funding and in exerting control in decision-making. Sustainability is also about how the organisation can work without over-dependence on key players. There are pluses and minuses for both these factors.

It is important to recognise the success PICC has had to date in being a sustainable and well governed organisation since the start given the issues that existed at commencement, in the context of the active barriers and challenges created by government policy and the challenges of a remote community context.

Currently, PICC may be in a state where the model is sustainable enough to continue operation. Ability to be sustainable could be greatly increased by more security of funded agreement timeframes and community-led decision making in the development and design of services needed, wanted and valued in the community.

While the current model was highly appropriate when PICC commenced, it needs to evolve to keep in line with the community context and feedback on expectations.

Adaptation to this model is currently underway to a community-controlled model.

Sustainability status considerations include:

- Funding is available on short-term contracts and is subject to political cycles.
- Some social enterprises operate on a profit-for-purpose basis so PICC can contribute to the local economy, increasing local employment and reducing the cost of living.
- A sound operational model exists for each social service and social enterprise.
- PICC has a stable organisational structure and workforce.

Success factors*

The commitment by and approach of the Board and the model of operation have changed a serious, fragmented and unstable community situation to one that provides ongoing positive community-level impacts.

Since inception it has been essential to rely on external expertise and management to drive performance and strategy at board level. However, this may need to evolve to bringing in experts as needed to support better informed community controlled decision making.

- A strong workforce strategy has been effective in providing training and employment to local workers as well as providing benefit to PICC in understanding appropriate cultural knowledge and service provision in the Palm Island community. This has provided the foundation for future localised sustainable operations.
- Senior and mid-level management has been consistent, and this continuity of staff has meant operational stability and stable management.
- PICC has engaged and partnered with a range of stakeholders and service providers to bring additional capability to Palm Island, expanding services and reducing the community reliance on PICC.
- Having a range of contracts and partners and a large workforce pool has helped PICC adapt to changing situations and funding.

*Based upon all evaluation inputs including documentation, internal and external stakeholder opinions, service provider opinions and community feedback Ipsos has compiled a list of relevant success factors. These include those expressed by individuals (where deemed an appropriate judgement) in addition to those identified by Ipsos based upon evaluation processes.

- High levels of due diligence have been applied across financial management and in achieving cost efficiencies in line with funding availability.
- Some social enterprises with profit-for-purpose have been developed in a culturally appropriate manner. However, a significant investment was required to develop these businesses.
- The CEO has been consistent since the inception of PICC and her aspirations for Palm people has driven the acquisition of new and innovative services. Her willingness to take risks and to have the confidence services will “work” on Palm has resulted in a strong and growing organization. The CEO has nurtured a strong, loyal and consistent management team, many of whom have been with PICC since shortly after establishment. The corporate knowledge retained by this pool of experienced, long standing managers has resulted in quality improvement, and has lessened the risk of making errors.

Risk factors

PICC still relies heavily on government funding to deliver services. Without this funding, PICC could not continue to operate in its current capacity. Current short-term funding arrangements offer no continuity or security.

Government funding modality is also a potential block on PICC being able to evolve to provide a community-led and -controlled decision-making capability.

Internal and workforce risks to sustainability

- Succession planning for senior managers and Board members is required to ensure growth in organisational capability and stabilised and to allow for workforce transitions.
- There are allegations of bullying, harassment and preferential hiring and performance management. Human resource management needs to continue to take complaints seriously or risk PICC credibility and sustainability of workforce.
- The viability of FIFO workers could change

- at any time due to factors such as cost of employment, community cost drivers or pressure from local community members. Whilst the community is critical of FIFO it is not something PICC has direct control over. The lack of housing and small employable staff pool on Palm Island necessitates FIFO and because of this, it should not be raised as an issue PICC could improve.

Community risk factors

It could be easy for the community to misunderstand and mistrust PICC if positive, visible outcomes and a culturally appropriate delivery do not remain strong. PICC needs to consider how to address the following perceptions:

- PICC is still run by government, not by the community
- community have no say or voice in what occurs for community benefit
- PICC creates a monopoly or restrictions on other economic developments

There is a lack of clarity about PICC’s capability, funding and operating boundaries and limitations which makes PICC open to individual criticisms.

Transparency and clarity regarding PICC’s role, engagement and limitations in the community will help to minimise potential mistrust.

Other risk factors

- Being positioned as a welfare service subsidised by government rather than human services needed by the community
- Lack of working capital is a constant strain on the ability to innovate and develop new business lines. New ideas take capital to overcome the initial hurdles. PICC’s pool of working capital funds was used to develop current social enterprises. If any profit can be generated from these social enterprises, this profit needs to be directed back into the working capital fund to ensure innovation and that new business lines can continue to be developed.

Areas for improvement

Although it has been a positive example of program implementation, the current model of operation needs to evolve in line with the community situation and organisation maturity. Specifically, strategic approaches (already on PICC's agenda) are needed to increase or cede operational control to community. This is possible because there good local leaders and managers with capacity.

- Strengthening of succession planning will assist in building strategic capability in local leaders and managers.
- Strengthening the profit-for-purpose avenues to funding will reduce the need to rely on government funding to provide the services the community wants provided.

Human resources practices require further attention to ensure sustainability of operations and the workforce. The Staff Survey mentioned issues including:

- transparent recruitment
- complaints handling
- training needs assessments
- performance management
- staff communication and engagement.

Other employment-related suggestions for PICC management and Board to consider include:

- address over-crowding in workplaces
- improve security for staff
- provide more tailored training
- improve communication and interaction between management, the Board and staff.

It is acknowledged that PICC already has strategies in place to address many of the HR staffing and system issues identified in this report; although addressing these to the extent required will take time to appropriately identify and build capability of the PICC

workforce beyond that which already exists and to identify and implement more sophisticated (but cost effective) HR systems.

The Staff Survey raised other potential improvements to consider regarding the future expansion of services:

- Some services will need to be improved so they can meet specific clients' needs, even in the face of funding restrictions. Staff-based workshops and review of Staff Survey data will provide tactical ideas.
- There is a real need in the community for more banking services and support with managing personal finances.
- Intensive support youth services.
- Community garden or food production.



T-shaped people ...

... are experts in at least one thing (vertical) but capable in many other things (horizontal).

PICC has, and needs to continue to foster, T-shaped people in the workforce. T-shaped people build skills in one area by working their way up through PICC and gaining a deep understanding of the organisation. When these people are in supervisor and manager positions, they are able to easily slide across silos and service areas and apply their skills in that context. The Board and management consider that T-shaped people are essential to PICC's sustainability, not only to support building local and sustainable capability, but also to successfully lead newly funded programs.



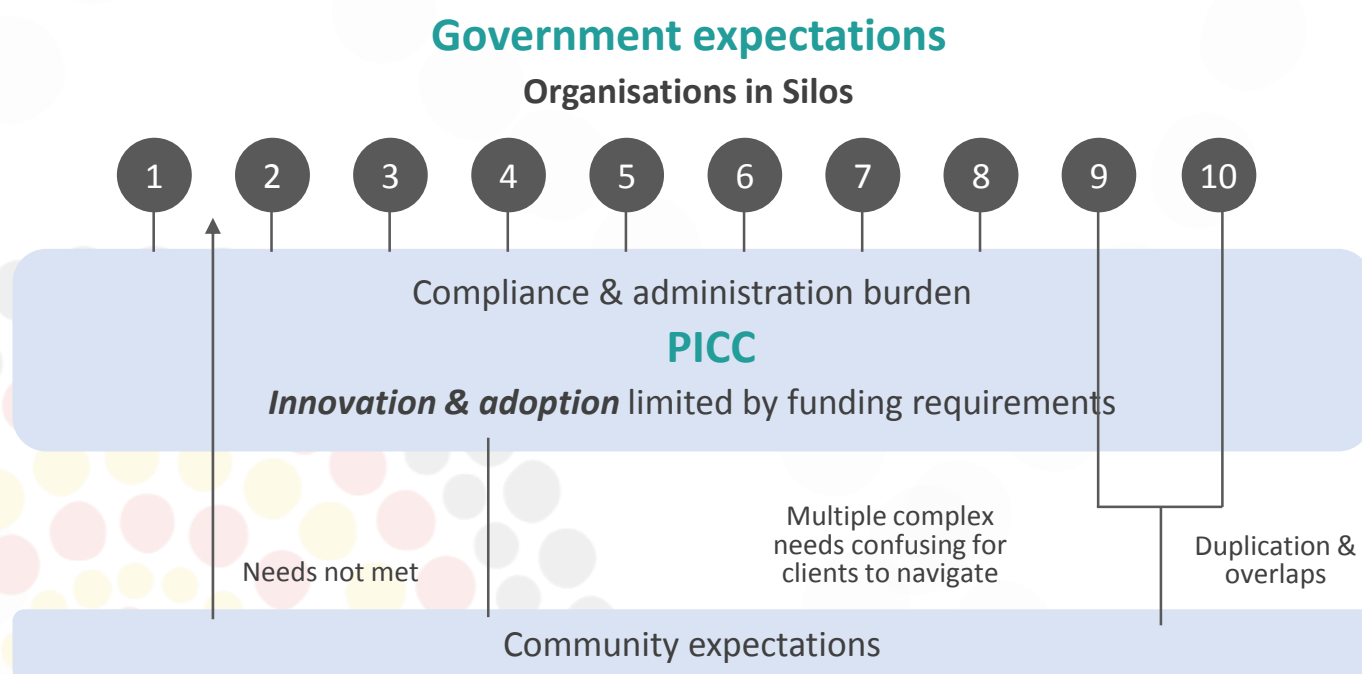
4. CONSIDERATIONS FOR STRENGTHENING PICC

4.1 Funding modality changes could strengthen the PICC model

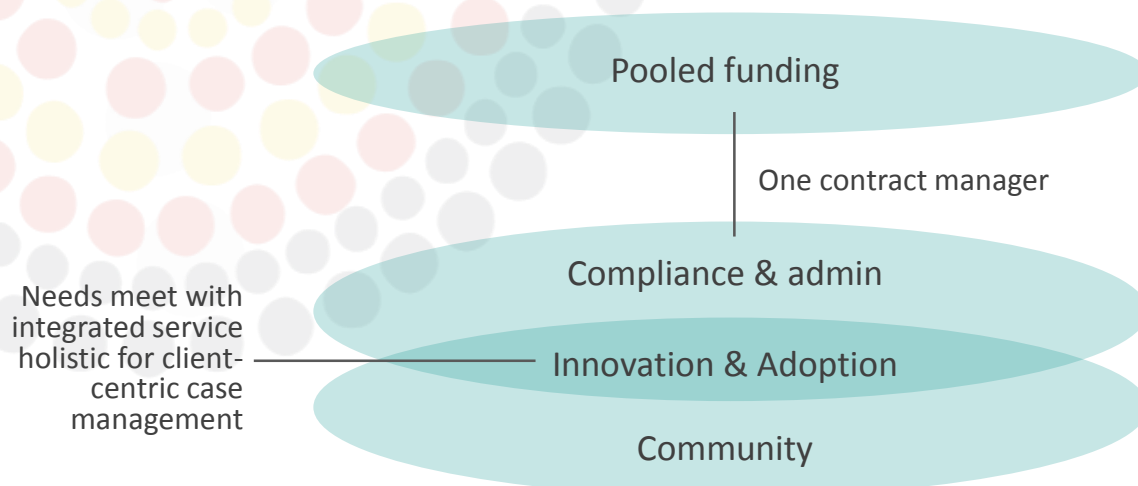
The Queensland Productivity Commission's Inquiry into service delivery in remote and discrete Indigenous communities examined how resources can best be used to meet the needs of those communities. The findings of the report, released on 22 June 2018, give promise to a reform agenda that may address the large network of administrative silos and allow more community-led decision-making with support for local authorising bodies.

An ideal funding model supports service delivery that is adaptive and responsive to the needs of the individual and supports decision-making by the community. Any decision-making body must have the authority to represent all people in the community for whom it makes decisions. This authorising body must not be self-serving, but must be able to manage factional conflict or family disputes in the community and work to everybody's best interests.

Government drives the agenda for what is funded when and where. In the first 10 years, PICC has been working in this way:



A move towards a **flexible pooled-funding modality** where local authorising environments would shift the model to drive the agenda on what is funded in their community it would work in the following way:



4.2 Governance changes could strengthen the PICC model

Transitioning to community control

After careful deliberation, the PICC Board resolved in August 2018 to pursue a corporate restructure that will transition the organisation to full a community control and developed a preferred model. Consultation with key stakeholders has commenced and legal advice sought to progress this decision. The decision and the proposed changes to PICC's corporate governance model are underpinned by research into leading practice in Indigenous corporate governance across Australia and the outcomes of this impact evaluation that clearly demonstrate community support for such a change.

The proposed model

The restructure involves the relinquishment of shareholding in PICC by the Ordinary Shareholders (Queensland Government and PIASC) and transition to a Company Limited by Guarantee. Membership of the new Company will be open to adult Palm Islanders who will elect the majority of directors. The Board will also include a Traditional Owner representative and have the power to appoint up to two independent directors to fill skills gaps. It is increasingly common for larger Indigenous organisations across Australia to adopt such a 'hybrid' governance model in order to achieve both community and external accountability. In developing the new governance model, the PICC Board's goal has been to carefully balance community participation in decision-making processes and accountability to the community with the need to ensure stability, sustainability, regulatory compliance and accountability to other stakeholders.

Progress

Consultations with Ordinary Shareholders has commenced, with PIASC resolving to support the proposed changes and indications of support from the Queensland Government subject to further consideration of the detail.

The intention to restructure was flagged to the community at the PICC Annual General Meeting in November 2018 and was positively received.

The law firm Allens Linklaters has been engaged to provide pro bono legal advice for the restructure.

A draft constitution, objects and advice on the transition process are completed, and these will form the basis for staff, community and stakeholder consultations to confirm the new model and timing for the transition.

The next evolution of the PICC model requires a shift towards greater community-led decision-making and ultimately a **community-led control base** for PICC. It is only by empowering the community to take their community's future into their own hands that this model will be fully sustainable.

This journey may take time, with many guiding hands, and it is unclear at which point community control can be achieved. However, PICC Board and management agree this is the way forward. They require the support of other stakeholders to work towards realising this outcome.

Giving that Palm Island community will have the ability and capability to control PICC decision making in future will ease some tensions regarding mistrust of PICC. PICC will continue to identify services that will be most instrumental and valued by the community and to find the best way to deliver these in a cost-effective and culturally appropriate manner. However, a community-controlled model is not without its risks, especially if local leaders and managers are ill-equipped to provide the strategic oversight and operational capabilities or if leaders are influenced to make decisions based on their personal ties and family connections. Appropriate succession planning and maintenance of select strategic advice roles will be required.

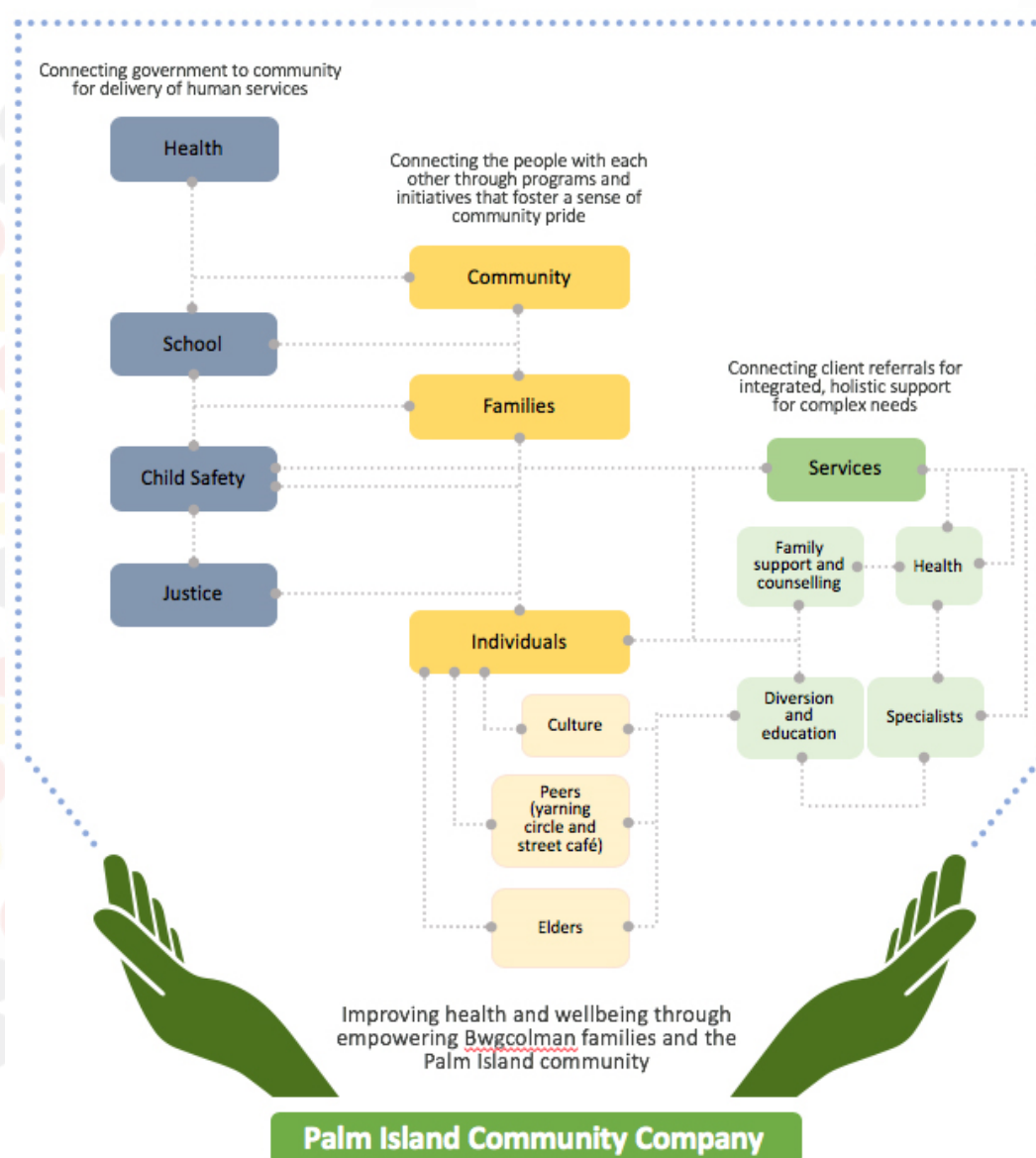
4.3 Client-centric considerations could strengthen the PICC Model

Currently PICC holds an organisation persona of a ‘connector’ – it is purposeful, meaningful, deliberate and enabling. This persona is relevant for the activities PICC has conducted to date, the activities it continues to conduct today and to help shift and guide the organisation towards a community-led control base.

PICC connects:

- government to community for the delivery of human services
- people with each other through programs that foster a sense of pride.
- client referrals for integrated holistic support for complex needs.
- a network of service providers and specialists and facilitates these connections and networks.

The aim in the future is also for community to come together and work towards a self-sustaining and proudly independent organisation that connects and provides services.



4.4 Operational considerations could strengthen the PICC model

Human resources are one of the most valuable assets that PICC has, and it requires greater attention and resources so that PICC can strengthen its capacity to be sustainable. It is through the stable, local and skilled workforce that positive outcomes and all achievements have been realised to date. PICC recognises this and a focus on human resources and strategy are on the current agenda.

The evaluation has highlighted that **local Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander employment is central to the success** of the model. It is a symbiotic and reciprocal relationship – PICC creates local employment opportunities that facilitate programs being delivered and social and community goals being achieved; at the same time local employees allow PICC to be culturally relevant and integrated. The emphasis on local Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander employees being central to the PICC model is a priority for community-led control.

Outcomes for PICC

Skills

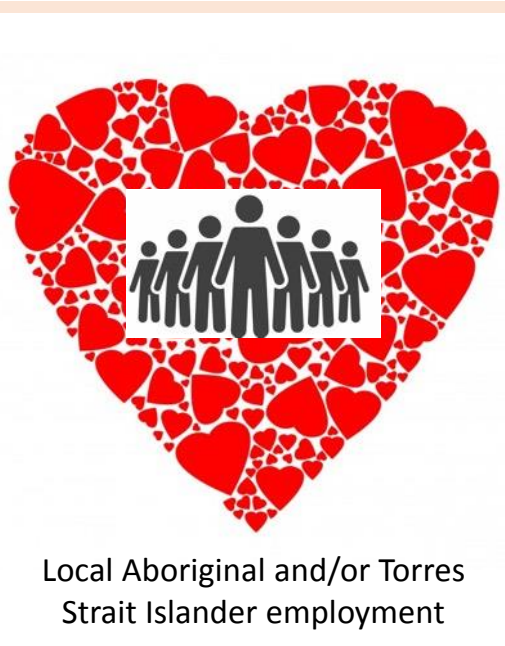
Other suppliers

Economic development

Go the extra yard (provides extra support and effort to make it work)

Good governance and high level of accountability

Direct delivery of high quality effective social services



Outcomes for individuals

Income / reduces joblessness / learning and training / whole households benefit / self-esteem

Demonstrates an alternative way of living, with a job

Improves community capacity

Improves social wellbeing

Can apply learning at home

Human resources strategy

- Systems to address concerns regarding health, safety, harassment and bullying
- Software and systems to support human resources and KPI reporting
- Increasing transparency of the good hiring and performance management processes to dispel perceptions of preferential practices
- Formal longer term training needs assessment to better understand workforce skill requirements
- Staff communication and engagement to improve their knowledge of what is happening because they are important advocates in the community.

Strengthening mid-level management

- Succession planning into mid-management and for mid-management
- Fostering better communication to community from the managers and the Board
- Fostering mid-level managers to handle more day-to-day operations
- Identification and development of T-shaped people
- More management living on Palm Island and/or more accessible to staff on Palm Island.

4.5 Reputation considerations could strengthen the PICC model

PICC has a perception problem within the community that requires concerted internal and external communication strategies. There are a number of misconceptions around what PICC does, what it is and what its purpose is. These misconceptions are a disservice to all the good that PICC does within the Palm Island community. While sentiment has become more positive over time, there is still a pocket of negative feeling in the community and with some stakeholders. Changing reputation is done through a display of 'actions' and the behaviour and skill of PICC employees. There is no dedicated funding, nor would the community want there to be, for this type of communication challenges. It must occur naturally and be genuine and this will take time.

Truth-tellers

- PICC prides itself on truth-telling towards government and has the credibility to have a say on reform inquiries, legislation and policy consultation.
- PICC needs to be a truth-teller to the community to address areas where mistrust exist, such as in hiring practices, perceived inequality regarding who gets receipt of funds and vouchers and the role of government in decisions.
- A community-controlled model will help with the believability of PICC being a truth-teller; however, PICC must first be a truth-teller to highlight to the country that it operates to deliver genuine community outcomes.

Behind the scenes

- In part, the issue of mistrust stems from community and other stakeholders not knowing the realities of the funding and operational model, the details of what occurs and why and not appreciating all the activities that occur behind the scenes. PICC staff feel the organisation runs on a very lean budget – but that is not how it is perceived.
- PICC regularly goes beyond funding to deliver in-kind help, such as money to individuals in need beyond their Emergency Funding allocations, workforce planning, providing of trauma support and filling the gaps in existing services to the community. PICC is resourceful and clever at working within the constraints of government funding.
- Part of truth-telling may include being more transparent and having conversations about everything that PICC does behind the scenes and beyond existing funding within privacy and confidentiality considerations.

Heroes and connectors

- A new story needs to be developed focusing on 'employee heroes' and the connector persona.
- Heroes are the individuals and the local stories about all the good they do and the direct outcomes that are achieved. PICC staff are extremely dedicated and go out of their way to get the job done. In some instances, these heroes are local staff who help to deliver services 'the right way'. In other instances, they are specialist skilled staff accepted by the community who bring essential skills to Palm Island for the benefit of the Palm Island community.
- These anecdotal stories need to be used to support the evidence of positive outcomes so that the community believes the good that PICC has done.
- Evaluate the successful outcomes and impact to keep telling the stories.

4.6 Practice considerations could strengthen the PICC model

Moving forward, PICC should learn from the experience of conducting this evaluation to improve monitoring of the program, internal processes and operational elements and the outcomes for the community. This will assist in future evaluation processes, in communicating achievements internally and externally, in increasing transparency and in improving service delivery.

The systems used currently to capture data are simplistic and reliant on individuals who are stretched in their current roles. There is limited capacity and access to high quality, available data across the organisation.

It is recommended that PICC strives towards a culture where **monitored learning is embedded at multiple levels, and a clear evaluation framework** is established and assessed regularly.

The primary learning opportunities from PICC activities are reliant on supervisors and managers from existing service delivery streams being able to convey successful elements and areas that require improvement. Without these individuals, it would be difficult to understand what is working and what could use improvements.

For example, the current success of the CFC and Health Clinic is known but not yet documented so that learnings can be leveraged in the future. This service delivery model was successful because it was a generic and critical service applicable to the whole community. Its practices such as being culturally appropriate in workforce staffing, extended operational hours, ability to access services and timely access to specialist referrals have all been instrumental in positive outcomes and have led to an Aboriginal Medical Service (AMS) being set up on Palm Island.

All learnings related to this service delivery should be documented and applied back into new and existing ventures. A lot of the corporate knowledge of PICC sits within the senior management but is not well documented or transferrable either across the organisation or indeed to other community organisations wanting to learn. Additional resources may be needed to ensure knowledge transfers.

It is recommended that PICC establish a system of measuring impact via a community dashboard of qualitative and quantitative data using Indigenous knowledge and Indigenous data sovereignty principles.

This evaluative system would have indicators for success that are values- and strengths-based to support operational learning. PICC would not need to rely solely on government statistics that are not easily accessible or meaningful in terms of being able to attribute contribution from PICC.

Ideally, evaluation capacity for this ongoing monitoring would be built with local Palm Island residents, again making opportunities for local employment and ownership.

It is acknowledged that there is no funding available and identified for this administrative process at this time and that PICC may not wish to divert resources to this against the priority of service delivery and client outcomes.

4.7 Evaluation could strengthen the PICC model

To evaluate the PICC would require a number of different lenses at each layer of the system. At the micro level looking at individual service delivery. At the meso level PICC would need to consider the organisational goals and evaluate achievement or otherwise. At a macro level how PICC is contributing to a integrated service response in a remote community, and then at a mega level how community controlled responses contribute to population outcomes for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people.

Mega – Whole of Government	PICC – Model for community-controlled service delivery in remote communities	
Macro – Inter-agency level model	Integrated Service Response Queensland Government establishment of a model for inter-agency responses for service intersections (health/justice/education/safety/culture)	Evaluate the model What are the early outcomes and impacts at the level of the macro system? Are elements of the community-controlled model working and/or how can they be improved? To what extent is community-controlled governance working?
Meso – Place-based trial	PICC Key Performance Indicators What does community value about the community controlled model and how can success be measured? How will Palm Island residents and stakeholders know if the model is working? What monitoring will help PICC achieve their goals?	Evaluate the organisation To what extent is community control governance working? To what extent does the PICC operate collaboratively? To what extent does the PICC operate effectively? To what extent does the PICC operate efficiently?
Micro – Service delivery	Services Appropriate service and supports that meets needs of users to improve social, economic, emotional, health and wellbeing outcomes for Palm Island residents. Right services at the right time delivered the right way.	Evaluate the experience What are the service user early outcomes and impacts? To what extent are the specific needs of users met? Are the services appropriate, tailored, wholistic and high quality?